



Concacaf

B DIPLOMA

REFERENCE MATERIAL





WHO WE ARE?

Our evolving Coach Education program emphasizes skill acquisition, growth mindset, meaningful feedback, and technology integration. This holistic approach, aligned with NCCP & Concacaf guidelines, reflects modern needs and is grounded in the 5 Core Principles below.

WE VALUE:



INQUIRY



OWNERSHIP



GROWTH



EQUITY



COMMUNITY

INQUIRY

Begin with curiosity and encourage learners to experience information within real-world contexts.





OWNERSHIP

Strike a balance between active support and inspiring students to make motivated, self-directed progress.

GROWTH

Value an open-mind, viewing challenges as opportunities, and the demonstration of effort and ability overtime.





EQUITY

Identify, remove, and prevent barriers and promote practices that help individuals reach their full potential.

COMMUNITY

Connect individual learning to the broader development of groups and societies.



WE EVALUATE

The Coach Education Principles provide the framework for evaluating competencies in:



CURIOSITY → *The ability to explore different contexts and meet diverse needs.*



ACCOUNTABILITY → *The ability to take responsibility for one's actions.*



OPENNESS → *The ability to focus on progress over perfection.*



LEADERSHIP → *The ability to guide others in a process of growth.*



TEAMWORK → *The ability to cooperate and collaborate with others.*

CURIOSITY

Based on the competency,
we support and assess the
following skills:

CLARITY

ADAPTABILITY

PROBLEM-SOLVING





ACCOUNTABILITY

Based on the competency,
we support and assess the
following skills:

ORGANIZATION
TIME MANAGEMENT
SELF-REGULATION

OPENNESS

Based on the competency,
we support and assess the
following skills:

EMPATHY

COMPASSION

CRITICAL REFLECTION





LEADERSHIP

Based on the competency,
we support and assess the
following skills:

AUTHENTICITY

ENGAGEMENT

RISK-MANAGEMENT

TEAM WORK

Based on the competency,
we support and assess the
following skills:

COMMUNICATION
RELATIONSHIP-BUILDING
CONFLICT RESOLUTION



DEVELOPING A GAME MODEL

1

WHO ARE WE?

Coach Philosophy, Team
Philosophy, Vision & Values

2

HOW DO WE WANT TO PLAY?

Playing Philosophy:
System-Strategy-Tactics

3

HOW DO WE COACH?

Practice Methodology, Coaching
Methodology & Process

4

FUTURE CANADIAN PLAYERS

Individual Development
Priorities: Skill Sets

GAME MODEL

“The game is very complex and requires a framework for players and staff to reference. With up to 22 players playing in a playing area of approximately 120 * 80 yards, with a unique set of rules, the game creates a matrix of continuous situations (problems) that players need to solve with time, space and game state stressors. Therefore, I believe the game needs to be compartmentalized into smaller components (moments and zones) each with a set of rules (principles) that the players can use to effectively navigate the game and opponents.”

Dalrymple (2024)



Strategy

WHAT

Tactics

HOW

Details

Skill Set

COACHING POINTS

WHAT

WHO-WHERE
WHEN-WHY

HOW

G

GUIDANCE

- Prescriptive – Provides advice & guidance
- Directional – Specifies direction & informs priorities
- Effectiveness orientated 'Do this...' to be effective
- Distinctive from its opposite or alternate

U

USEFUL

- Points towards desired results
- Describes how to be effective
- Supports making choices and decisions
- Utility resides in being interpretable, doable, feasible, and actionable

I

INSPIRING

- Values-based, ethically grounded
- Meaningful
- Is important, evokes a sense of purpose

D

DEVELOPMENTAL

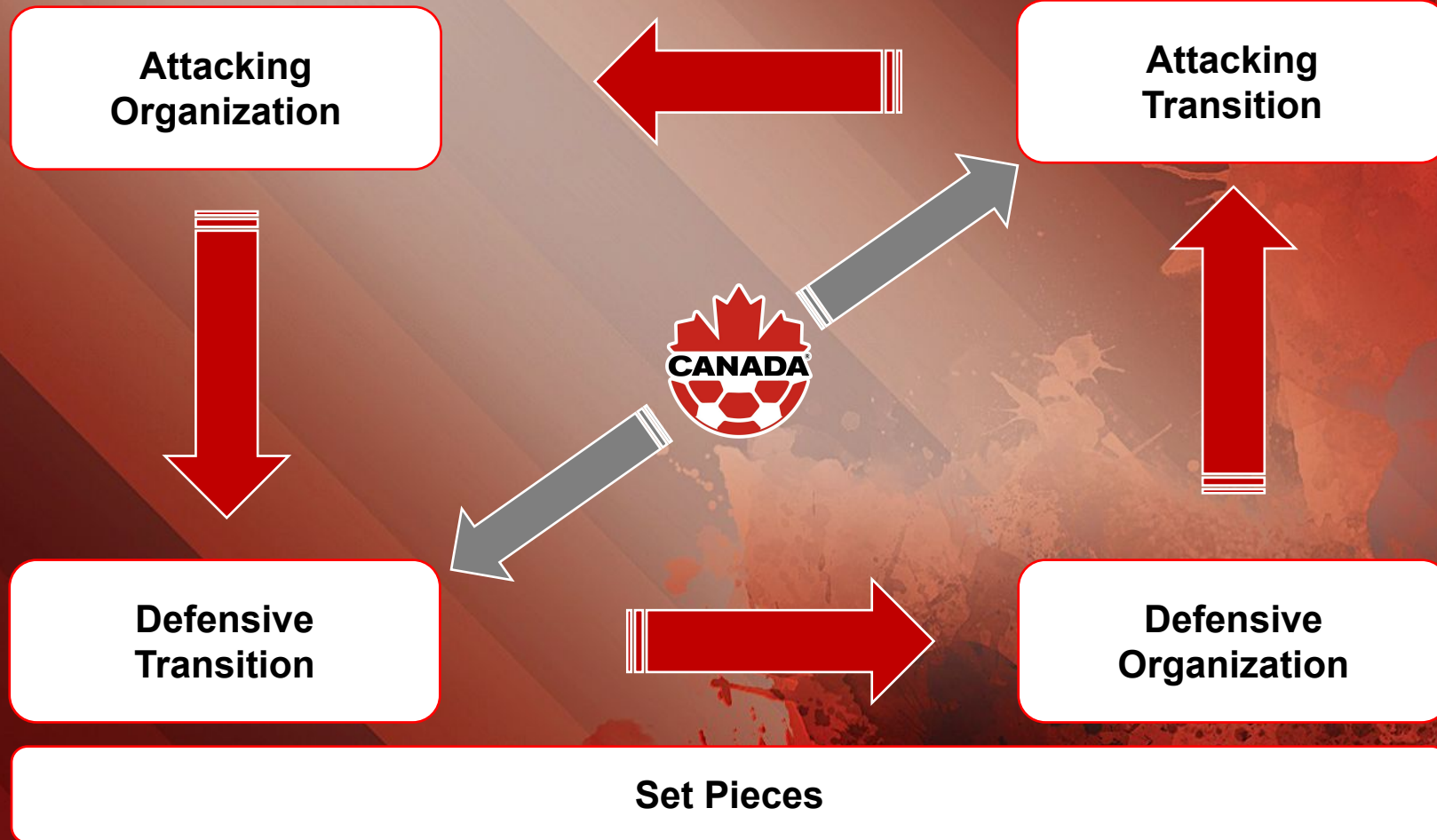
- Context Sensitive
- Complexity adaptable
- Enduring (not-time bound)

E

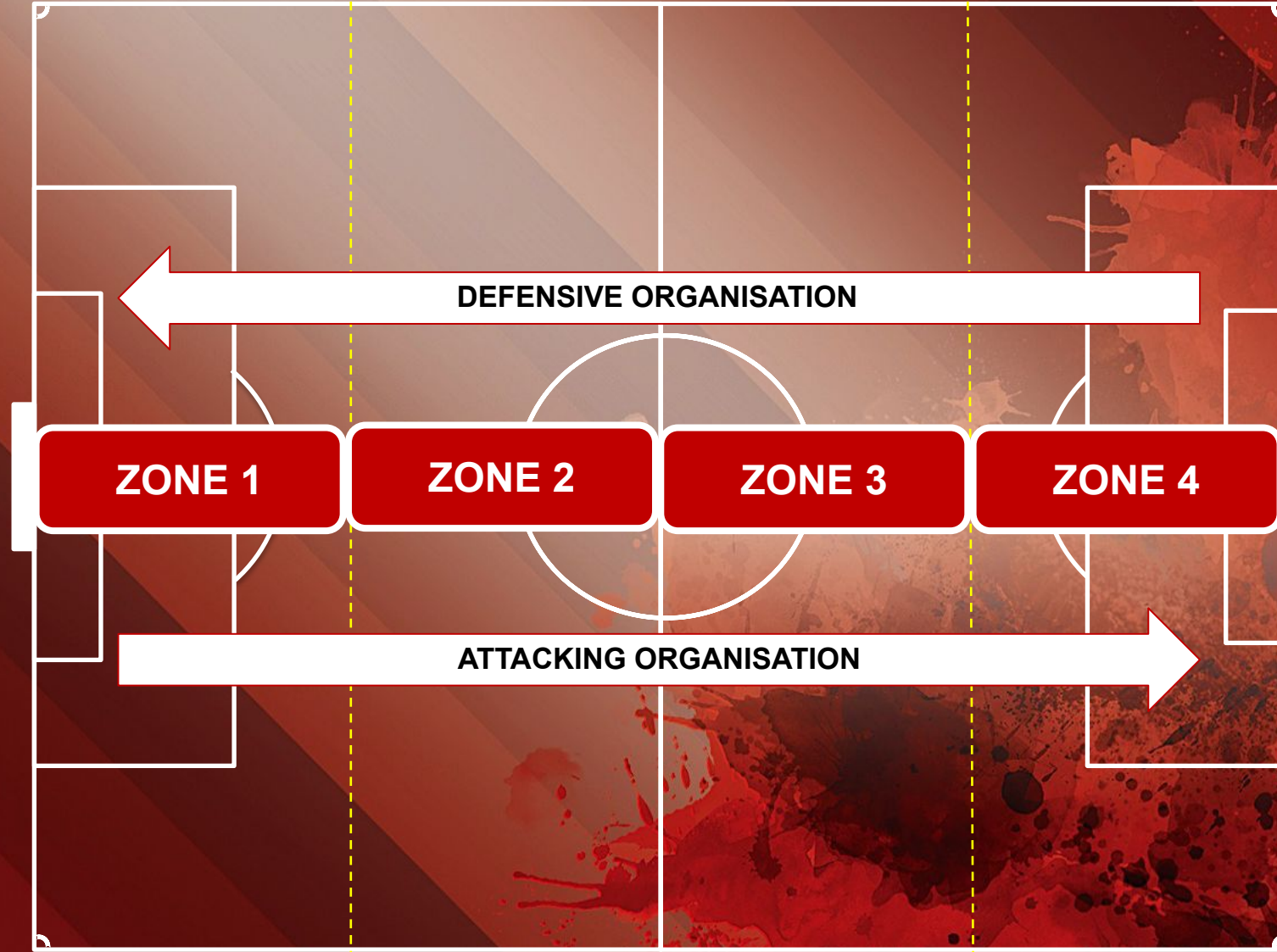
EVALUABLE

- Can document and judge whether it is followed
- Can document and judge what results
- Can determine if it takes you where you want to go.

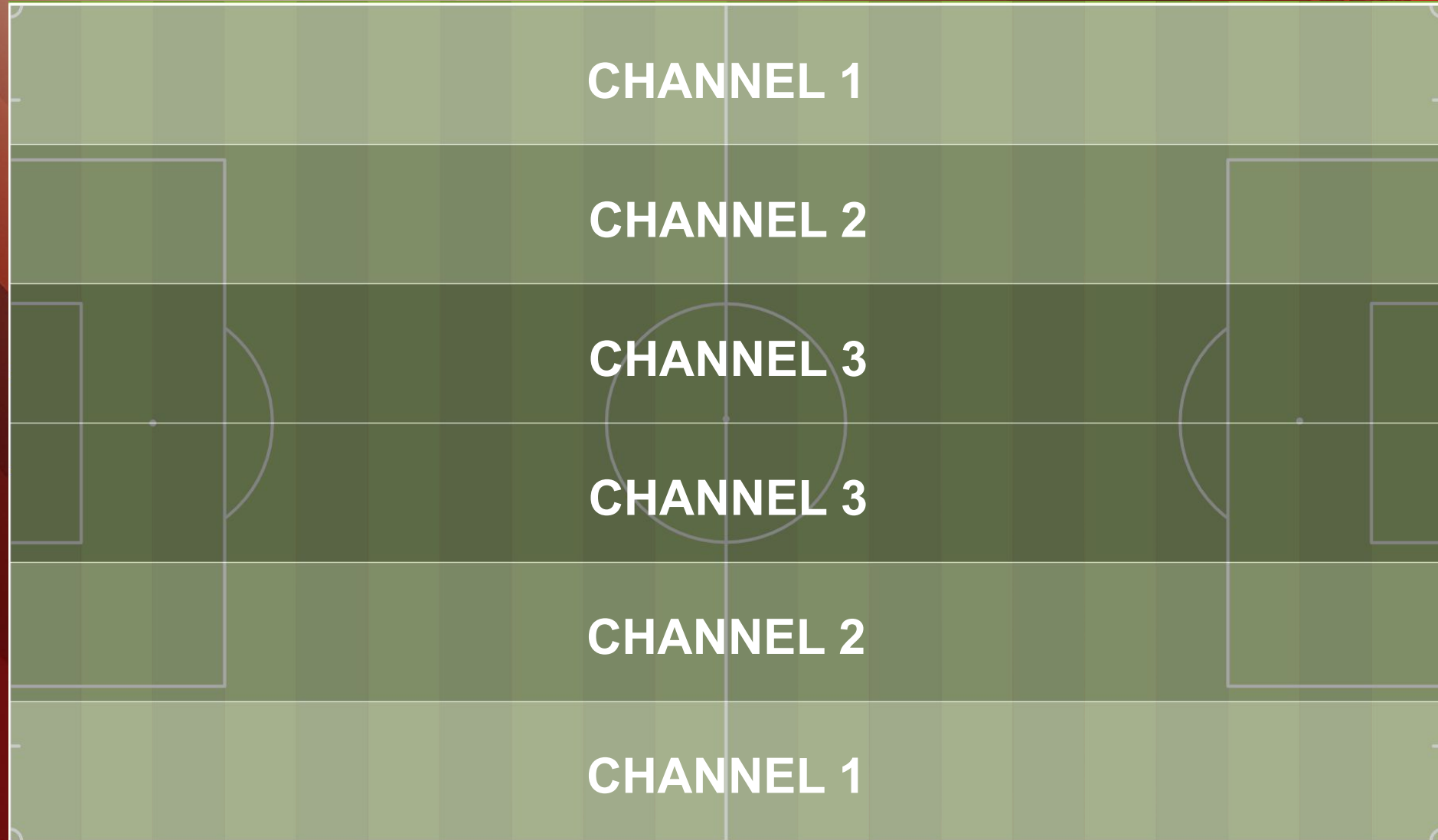
MOMENTS OF THE GAME



FIELD GEOGRAPHY



FIELD GEOGRAPHY



PRINCIPLES OF ATTACKING



DISPERSAL

Expand the team shape, creating space.



MOBILITY

Calculated movements of players to create opportunities.



IMPROVISATION

Actions and skills to eliminate opponents.

SUPPORT

The ability to receive the ball.



PENETRATION

Progress the ball towards the opponents goal.



PRINCIPLES OF DEFENDING



DENY

If you can win the ball back, win it.



DIRECT

Force the opponents to advantageous space.



BALANCE

Maintain team shape, denying space.

DELAY

If you can't win the ball back, delay the opponent making forward progress.



CONTROL AND RESTRAINT

Being patient to regain possession.



System

A system of play is to provide a range of structures, via the positional arrangement of players establishing communication channels for players into units to help achieve the desired strategy and tactics.



Strategy

Strategy refers to all plans, principles of play, or action guidelines decided upon before a match in order to organize the activity of the team and the players during the game.



Tactics

Tactics are defined as the principles guiding attacking and defensive actions that give immediate solution to the changeable situations influenced by the opposite team. They are the particular actions performed to fulfil the required strategy.



Skill Set

Skills involves solving game problems, using soccer actions in the right place at the right time to gain an advantage. Achieving this requires players to develop clever and effective individual tactics.



MOMENT OF THE GAME

FIELD GEOGRAPHY

System

1-3-4-3 High Press

Strategy

Force the ball to their left side (channel 1) to force direct play.

Tactics

Deny any inside pass (Tight Team)

Step up every time the ball moves backwards

Contest every direct call

Always +1 cover behind

Skill Set

Defensive actions:

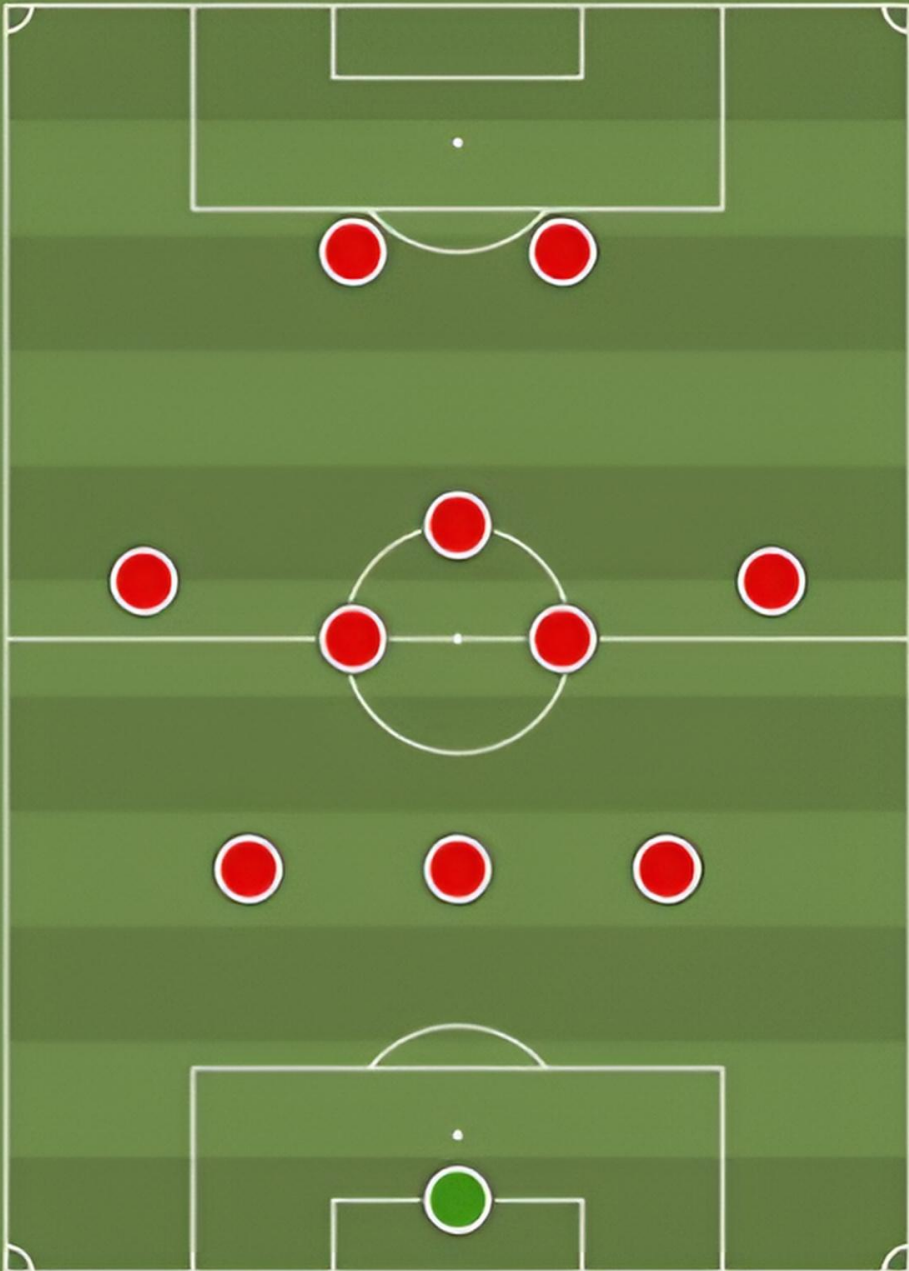
- Angle of approach
- Close the space down quickly, slowing down on approach
- Keep your feet moving
- Scanning



DEFENSIVE ORGANIZATION

ZONES 3-4

EXAMPLE



SYSTEM

Attacking and defending systems may be different depending on the team's skill sets and objectives before and during the match.

Example #1: A team might adopt a 1-3-4-3 defensive shape in zones 3-4 but adapt to a 1-4-4-2 in zones 1-2.

The objective of establishing a system of play is to provide a level of structure and establish communication channels for players into units to help achieve the desired strategy and tactics.

Example #2: A team might adopt a 1-3-4-3 defensive shape in zones 3-4 and need to consider the relationship of the lateral unit of the forwards to accomplish their strategy and tactics.

STRATEGY

Strategy in soccer refers to the plan a team makes for a particular match or situation. It can change from one match to another and even within the same match depending on the events that occur. Successful teams have pre-planned strategies based on variables such as pitch geography, players on the field, and the behavior of the opposing team.

Example #1: A team might adopt a strategy that they want to press high in zones 3-4 forcing their opponents to channel 1 to force direct play. However, if the opposing team breaks into zones 3-2 the strategy to drop into a medium block could occur.

Example #2: The opposing team might make a substitution and/or change of system which results in the strategy changing.





TACTICS

The way players manage/occupy the playing spaces, through their positioning and movements. Due to the dynamic nature of soccer, the objective is to establish unity across the team. We recommended coaches take a principle-based approach when guiding individual player decisions and actions, which will require the reaction of both units and the team to stay aligned to the established principles.

Example: If a team's strategy is to '**Force the ball to their left side (channel 1) to force direct play**' adopting the principle of '**Deny any inside pass (Tight Team)**' this requires a player closing the space, directs their opponents to the right side (individual decision-action) and the unit/team respond in alignment with this and other principles.

The coaches role through training is to coach the players on the specificity of implementing the principles ensuring unity by providing players details on

WHO-WHAT-WHEN-WHERE-WHY-HOW

SKILL SET

Skill set is a players bibliography of skills which involves solving game problems, using soccer actions in the right place at the right time to gain an advantage.

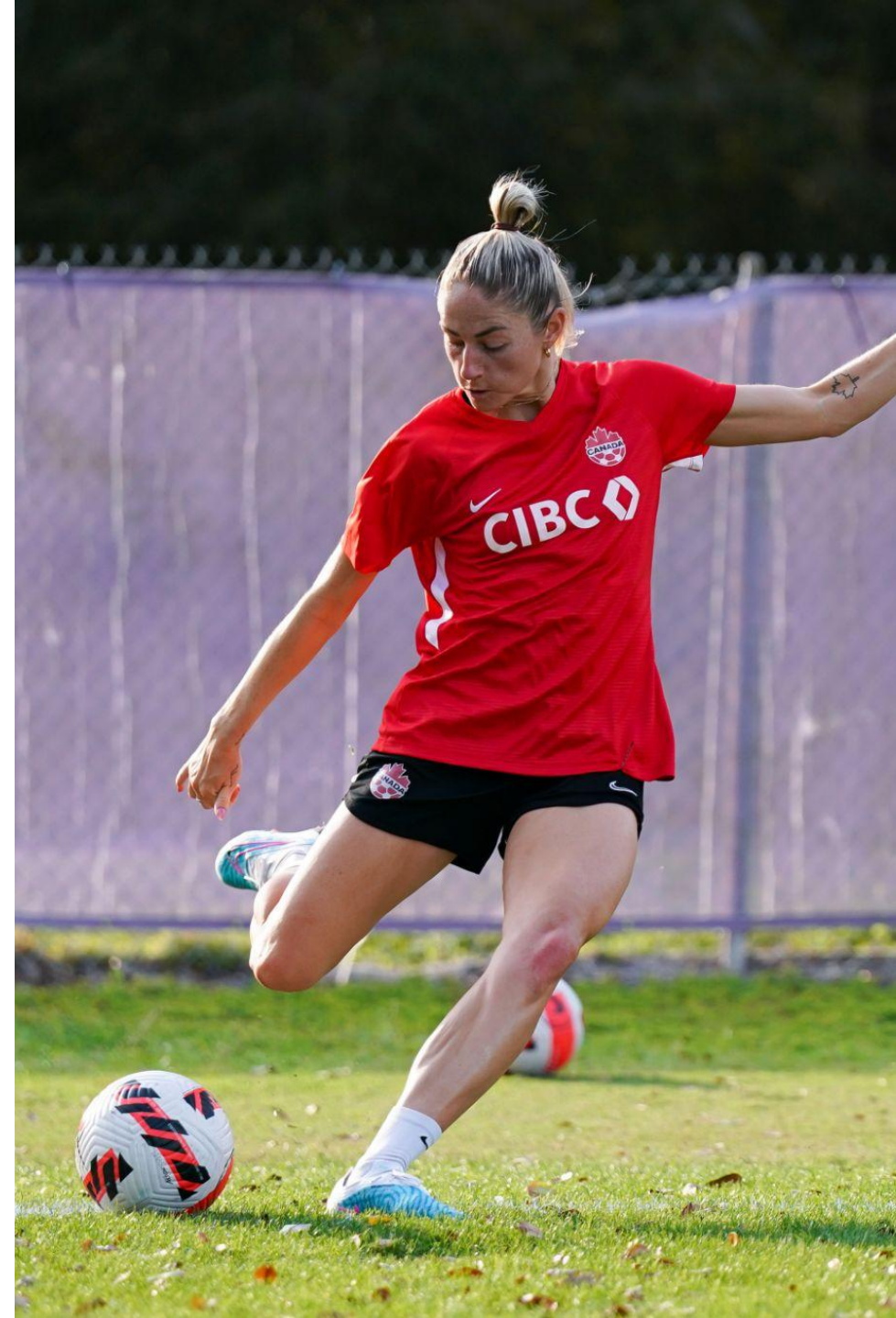
Your system, strategy, and tactics are influenced by your player's various skill sets.

Example: If your center backs skill sets are limited with reference to being comfortable on the ball. This will impact your approach on how you build attacks:

The system selected could reflect getting more **positions in zones 2-3 if playing higher (1-3-5-2).**

A strategy could be that you **play direct.**

A tactic could be to have **more numbers around any direct contests then the opponent.**



CONSIDERATIONS FOR PRACTICE SESSION DESIGN

System

A system of play is to provide a range of structures, via the positional arrangement of players establishing communication channels for players into units to help achieve the desired strategy and tactics.

Considerations for the activity:

- **Coherence in the system when matching both teams**
- **Choosing the correct activity that will allow to work the system**
- **Consider the system within the reference to the strategy**
- **Consider the system within the 4 moments of the game,**
- **Consider the system within the area of the pitch**
- **Others?**

CONSIDERATIONS FOR PRACTICE SESSION DESIGN

Strategy

Strategy refers to all plans, principles of play, or action guidelines decided upon before a match in order to organize the activity of the team and the players during the game.

Considerations for the activity:

- **Consider the four moments in the game**
- **Consider the area of the field**
- **Consider strategy of opposition**
- **Consider the context of the game (score/results)**
- **Consider the time of the game (minutes)**
- **others**

CONSIDERATIONS FOR PRACTICE SESSION DESIGN

Tactics

Tactics are defined as the principles guiding attacking and defensive actions that give immediate solution to the changeable situations influenced by the opposite team. They are the particular actions performed to fulfil the required strategy.

Considerations for the activity:

- **Consider the direct individual opposition**
- **Consider ability of the player (s) involved**
- **Consider the tactical behaviour in reference to the strategy**
- **Consider the behaviour/role within the reference to the system**

CONSIDERATIONS FOR PRACTICE SESSION DESIGN

Skill Set

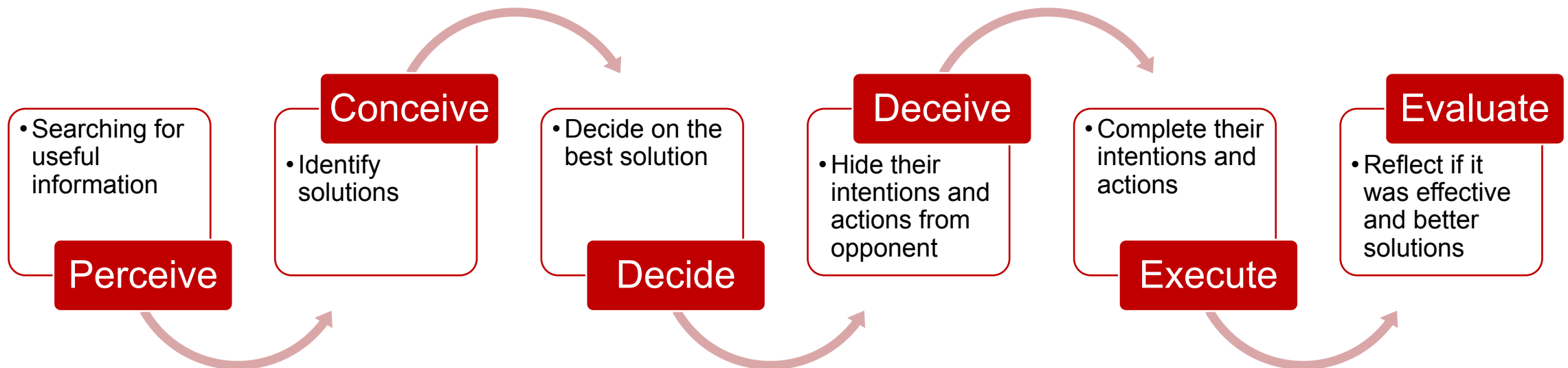
Skills involves solving game problems, using soccer actions in the right place at the right time to gain an advantage. Achieving this requires players to develop clever and effective individual tactics.

Considerations for the activity:

- **Consider the individual and group technical and physical ability**
- **Consider the technical demand with reference to strategy (playing direct vs playing build up for example)**
- **Consider the physical skill set (ability) with reference to strategy and system**

DEVELOPING SKILLFUL & ADAPTABLE PLAYERS

Decision Making Framework of a Player



SKILL DEVELOPMENT

	BEGINNER		INTERMEDIATE
	INITIATE	ACQUIRE	CONSOLIDATE
KEY POINTS TO LOOK FOR	First contact Participants may have no idea of what to do	Participants can coordinate and execute key components of movements May lack synchronization and flow (must think about how to do the movement)	Skill executed correctly Good synchronization and rhythm when not under pressure Inconsistent performance under pressure
PARTICIPANTS NEED	A clear mental picture of correct execution To feel safe doing skill To become comfortable with some of the movements	To understand what they have to do Lots of repetitions at slower pace To practice on both sides Trial and error with coach feedback	Lots of repetitions, under varied conditions To increase difficulty More trial and error with less feedback To practice under fatigue conditions

ENVIRONMENT DESIGN FRAMEWORK

DESIGN

DEMANDS

EXPERIENCES - OBJECTIVES - LEARNING INTENTIONS

ORGANIZATION - STRUCTURE - ACTIVITIES

PITCH

PARAMETERS

REWARD

RELATE

PLAYERS

RESTRICT

ENVIRONMENT DESIGN FRAMEWORK

DESIGN

DEMANDS

EXPERIENCES - OBJECTIVES - LEARNING OUTCOMES

ORGANIZATION - STRUCTURE - ACTIVITIES

PITCH

PARAMETERS

REWARD

RELATE

PLAYERS

RESTRICT

LEARNING INTENTIONS

A learning intention is a statement, created by the coach/teacher, that **describes clearly what the coach/teacher wants the students to know, understand, and be able to do** as a result of learning and teaching activities.

Clear learning intentions should help players/students focus not just on the task or activity taking place but on what they are learning.



LEARNING INTENTIONS

THE BENEFITS

Players will
become more
focussed on
tasks and
persevere for
longer

Behaviour
will
improve

Feedback
is easier

There is rich
dialogue

The quality in
performance
improves

ENVIRONMENT DESIGN FRAMEWORK

DESIGN

DEMANDS

EXPERIENCES - OBJECTIVES - LEARNING OUTCOMES

ORGANIZATION - STRUCTURE - ACTIVITIES

PITCH

PARAMETERS

REWARD

RELATE

PLAYERS

RESTRICT

DIFFERENT METHODOLOGIES

WHOLE METHOD

Whole practice is when the skill is simply learnt all in one go. This method of skill acquisition is mainly suited to low organisational skills, where there are few decisions to be made.

WHOLE PART WHOLE METHOD

The whole part whole practice method is when a coach observes the whole skill before identifying areas to improve. The coach would then develop and improve an area within their performance before bringing the whole skill back together.

PROGRESSIVE PART METHOD

Different parts of the skill are practiced, then linked together to form larger parts of a longer, more complex skill.

PART METHOD

Part Method is when the skill is split up into its different parts. Each part is then learnt separately, and once each part has been perfected, they are all done together to re-create the whole skill.

WHOLE PART WHOLE + -

Uses all stages of learning.

The whole skill is practiced early.

The performer can get a rough grasp of the skill by attempting it first.

Difficult for low ability/de-motivated learners.

Lots of information to be processed.

CONSIDERATIONS: Coaching philosophy, Motivation of the players,
Opportunity to explore System-Strategy-Tactics

PROGRESSIVE + -

Longer skills can be split up
and may be easier to
remember.

Limited awareness of the
whole skill.

More complex skills are made
easier to learn.

Transferring to whole skill may
remain difficult.

Time-consuming.

CONSIDERATIONS: Introduction of new or complex objectives/outcomes,
Periodization outcomes, Higher frequency of player contacts

PART + -

Increases confidence and motivation.

Takes a long time to learn each part and put it together.

Easier for the learner to grasp the skill.

Limits the awareness for the whole skill

Maybe de-motivating for high-ability learners.

CONSIDERATIONS: Complex objectives/outcomes, Periodization outcomes, High frequency of player contacts, Position specific sessions

WHOLE + -

It is significantly quicker than other practices to learn skills.

Difficult for low ability learners.

Can be de-motivating if skill is done wrong.

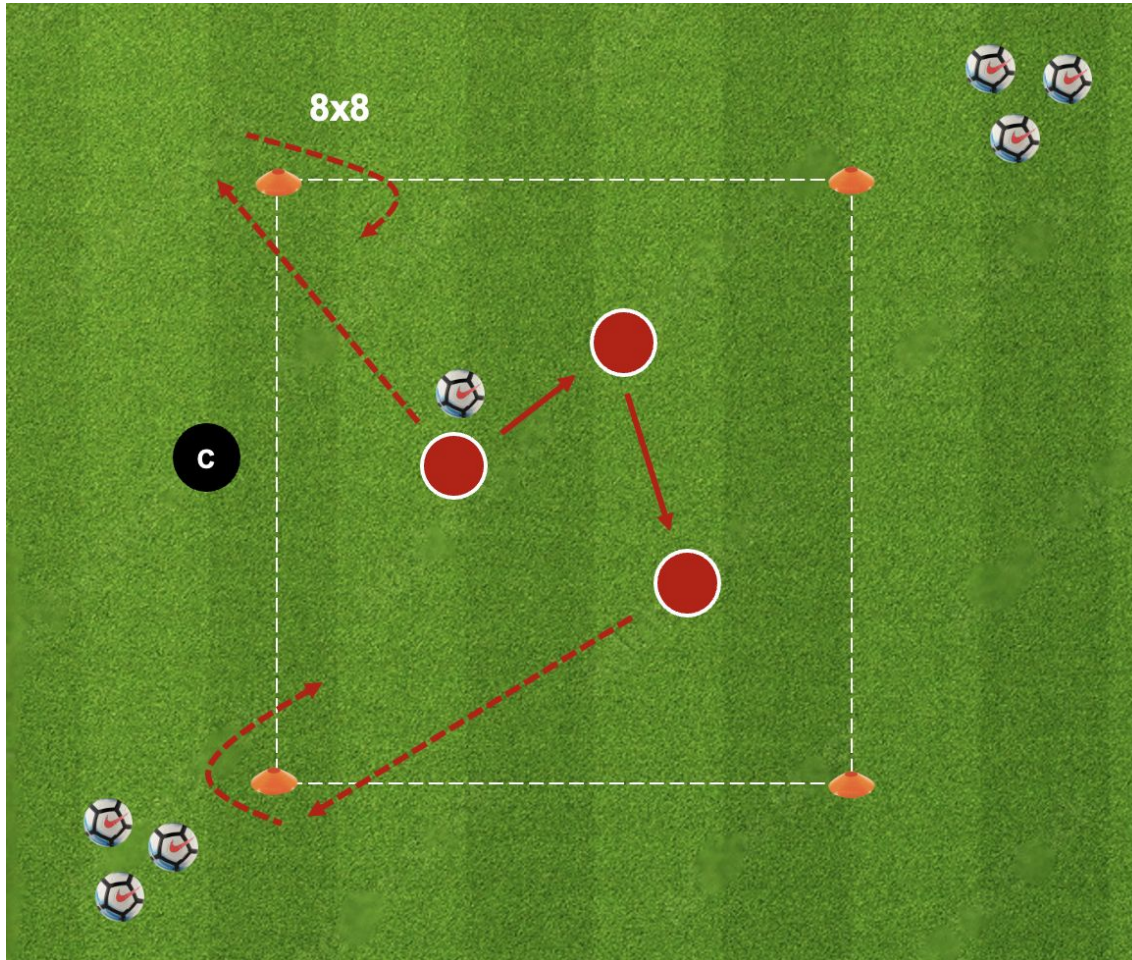
Good for high ability learners.

Creates a mental picture.

Can be too fast for some learners.

CONSIDERATIONS: Access to resources, Maturity of the players, Number of players, Opportunity to explore System-Strategy-Tactics

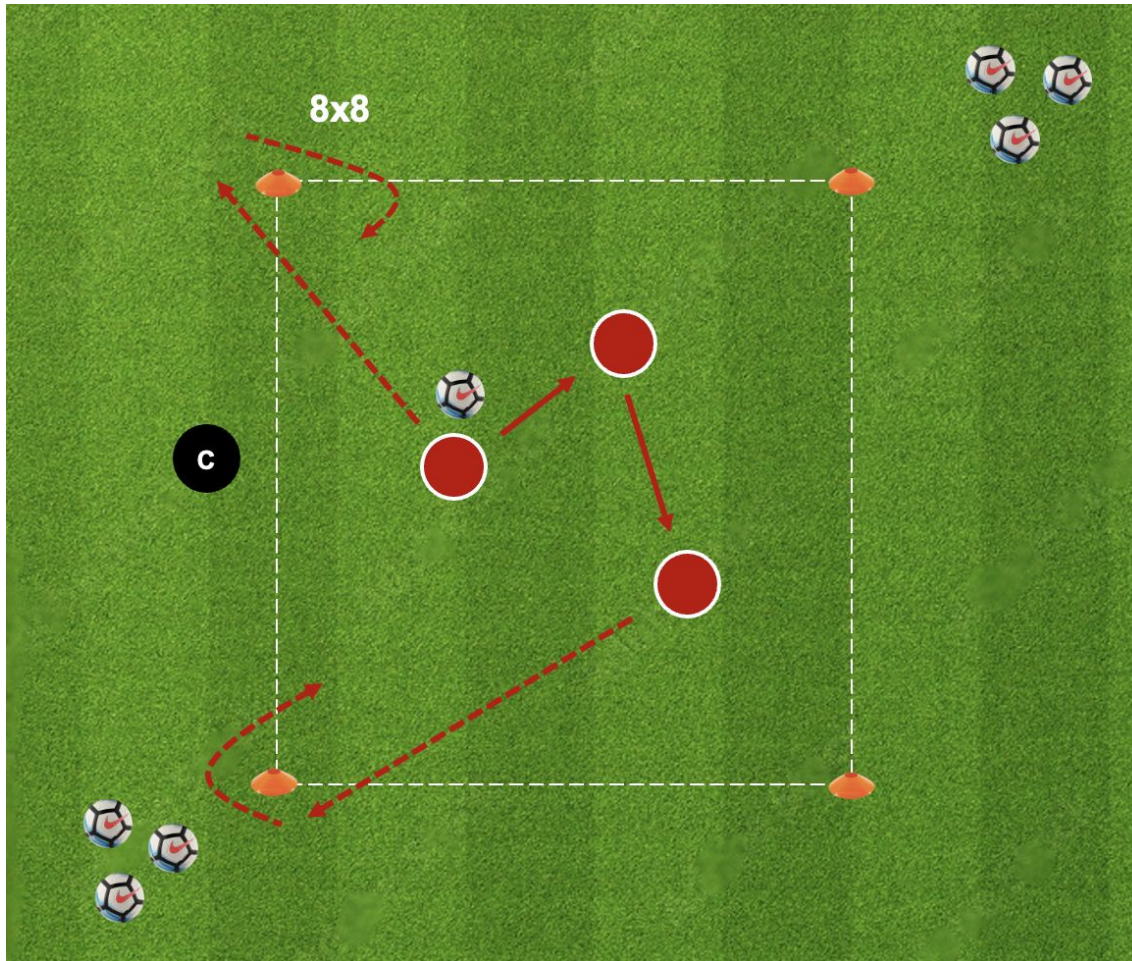
TECHNICAL ACTIVITY



A technical practice designed specifically to introduce new and innovative technical elements

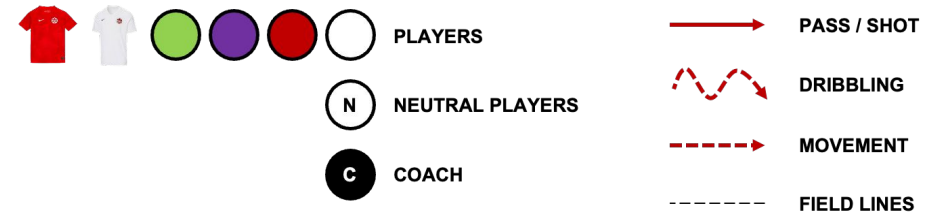
A practice to enhance and extend existing technical competencies relating to playing positions, roles, responsibilities and operational circumstances.

TECHNICAL ACTIVITY

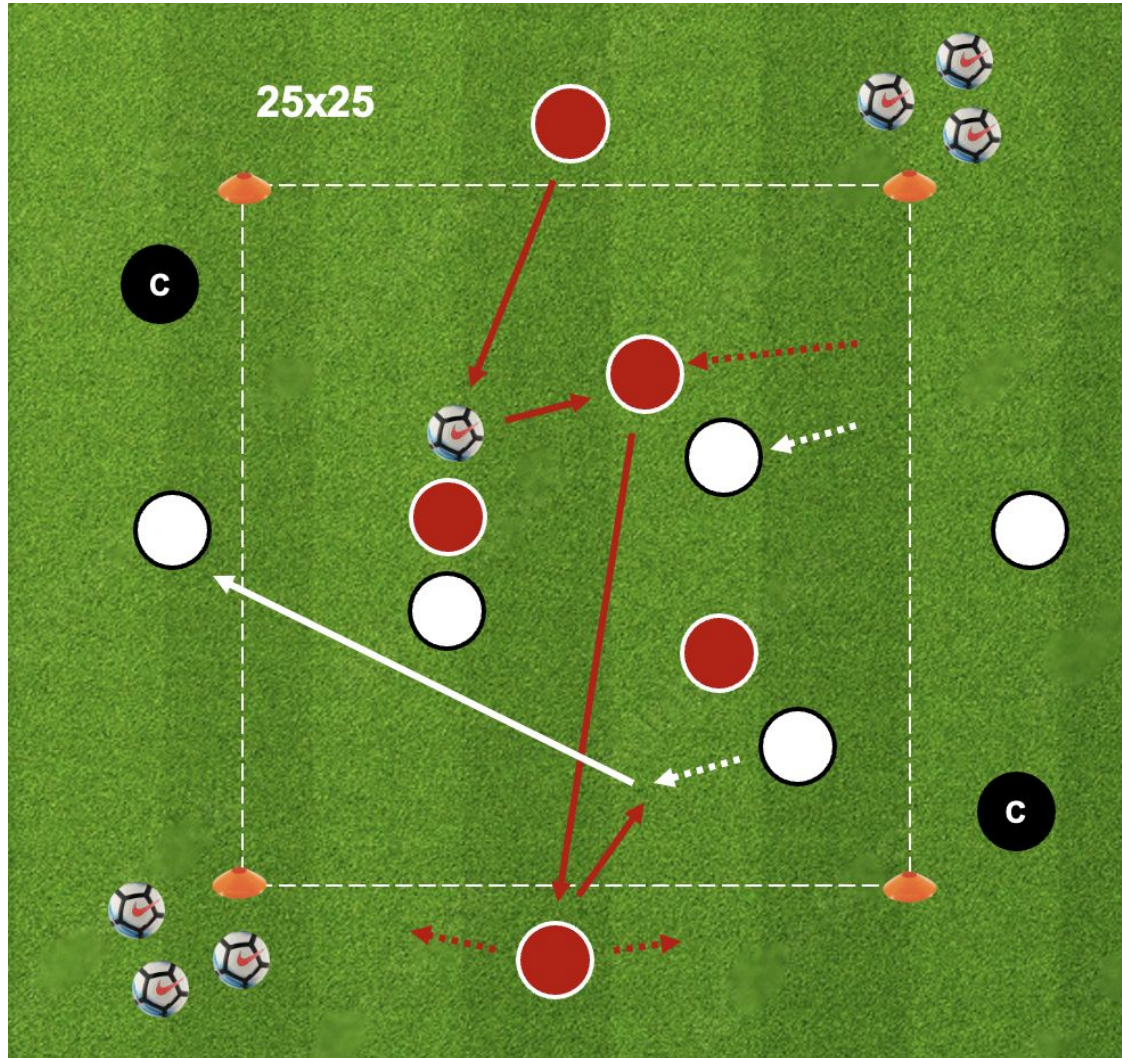


To consider:

- Avoid linear activities with technical part
- Include many repetitions, some decision making and minimal perceptual demands



SKILL ACTIVITY

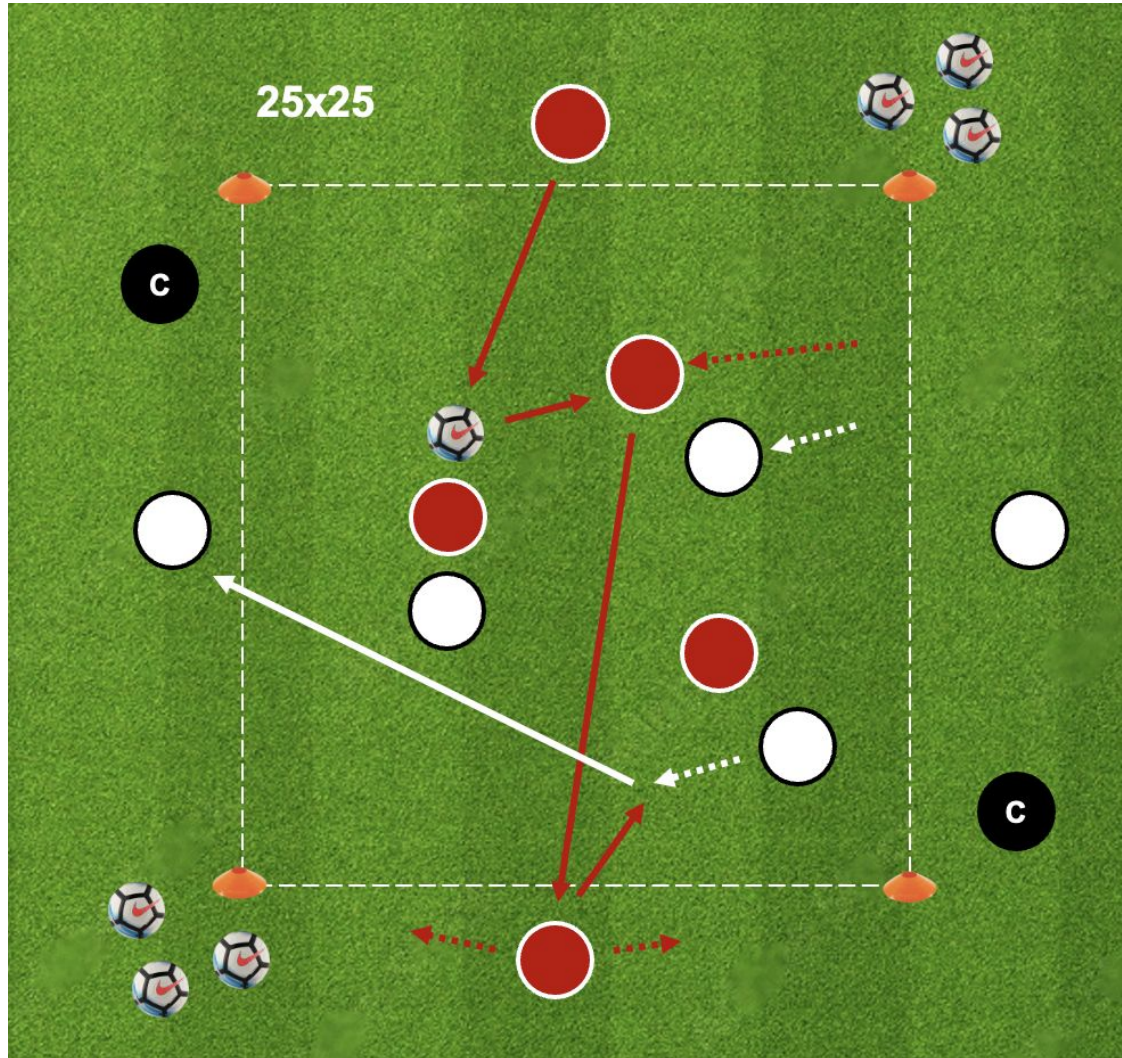


This is an opposed practice with the emphasis on solving game problems, using soccer actions in the right place at the right time to gain an advantage.

The practice contains objectives for all players that are derived from the objective being practised.

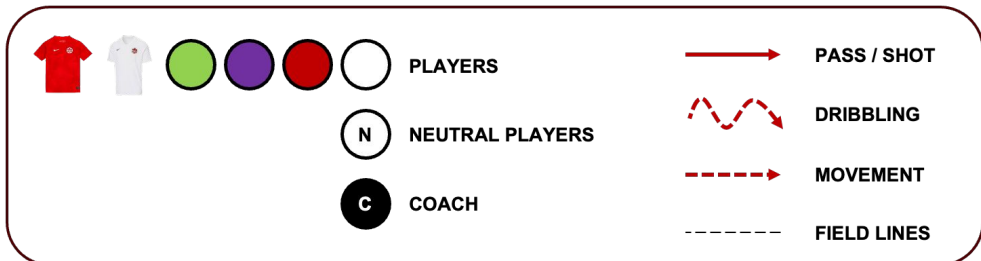
Appropriate areas, the number of players involved and constraints will vary around the objective.

SKILL ACTIVITY

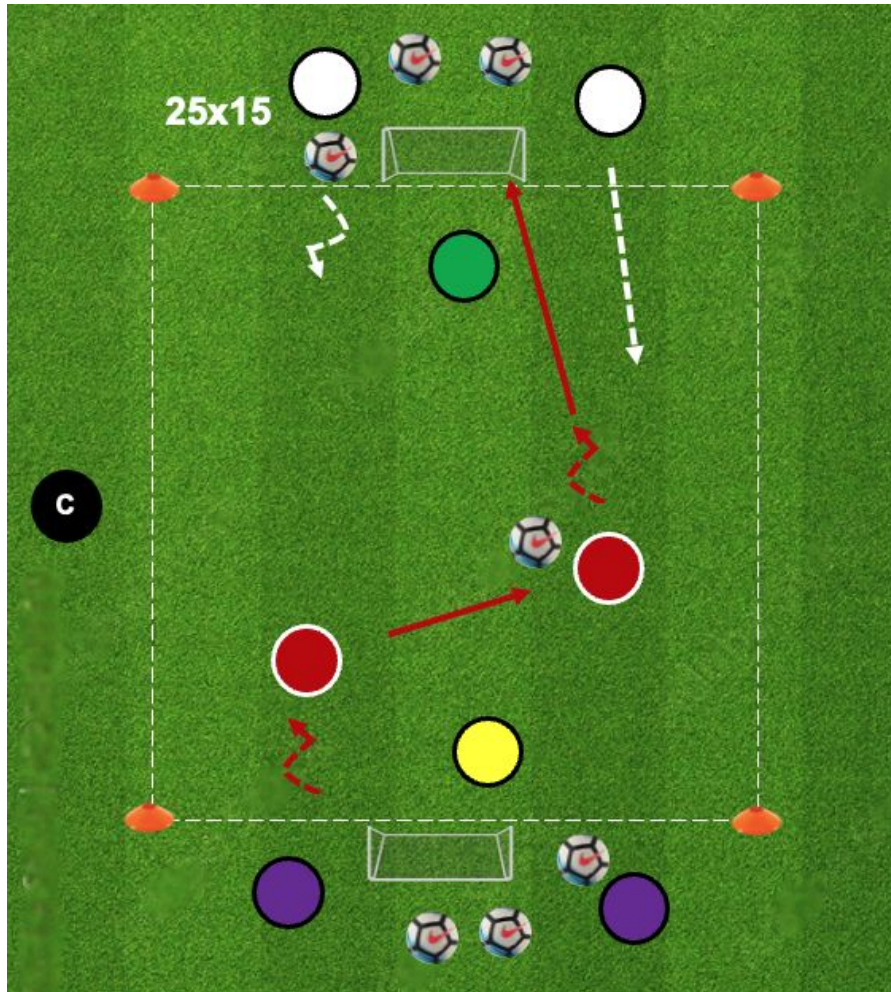


To consider:

- Goal orientated
- Identify direction of play
- Focus on playing forward
- Decision making activities for players
- Ideal space for activity
- Proportional number of players to space
- Flow of play
- Rest work ratio



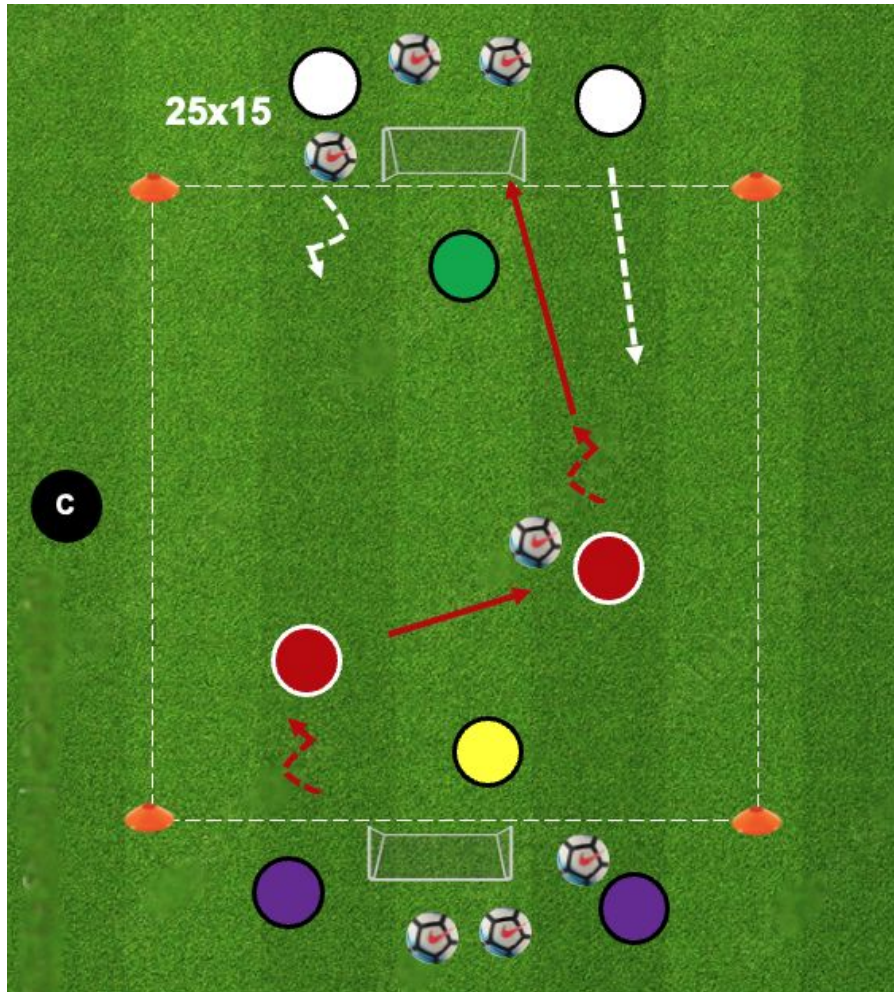
WAVE ACTIVITY



This practice can range from unopposed to opposed, based on demand.

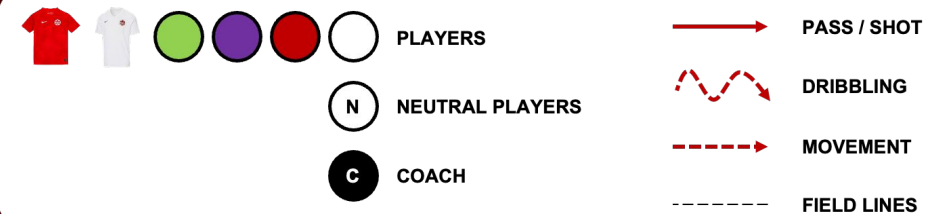
Groups are arranged within the practice to ensure the continuous repetition of both attacking and defending functions.

WAVE ACTIVITY

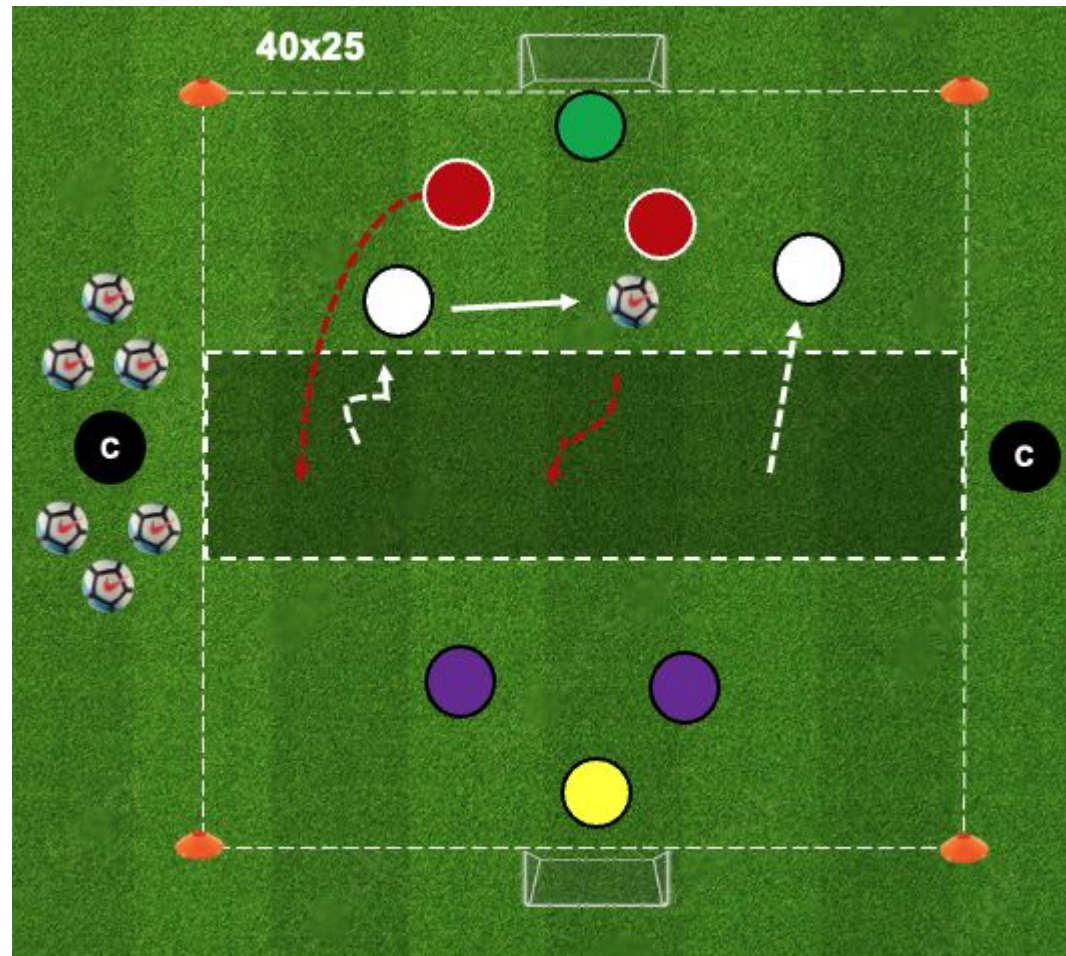


To consider:

- Identify direction of play when possible
- Decision making activities for players
- Ideal space for activity
- Proportional number of players to space
- Flow of play
- Rest work ratio

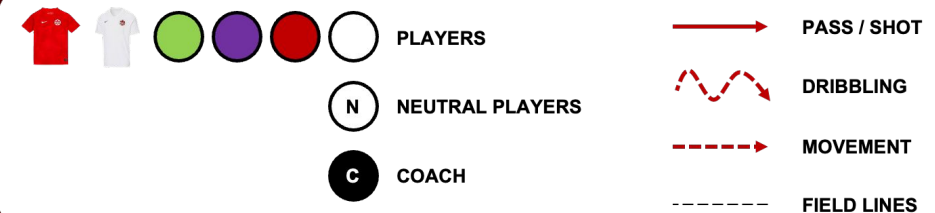


WAVE ACTIVITY WITH OPPOSITION

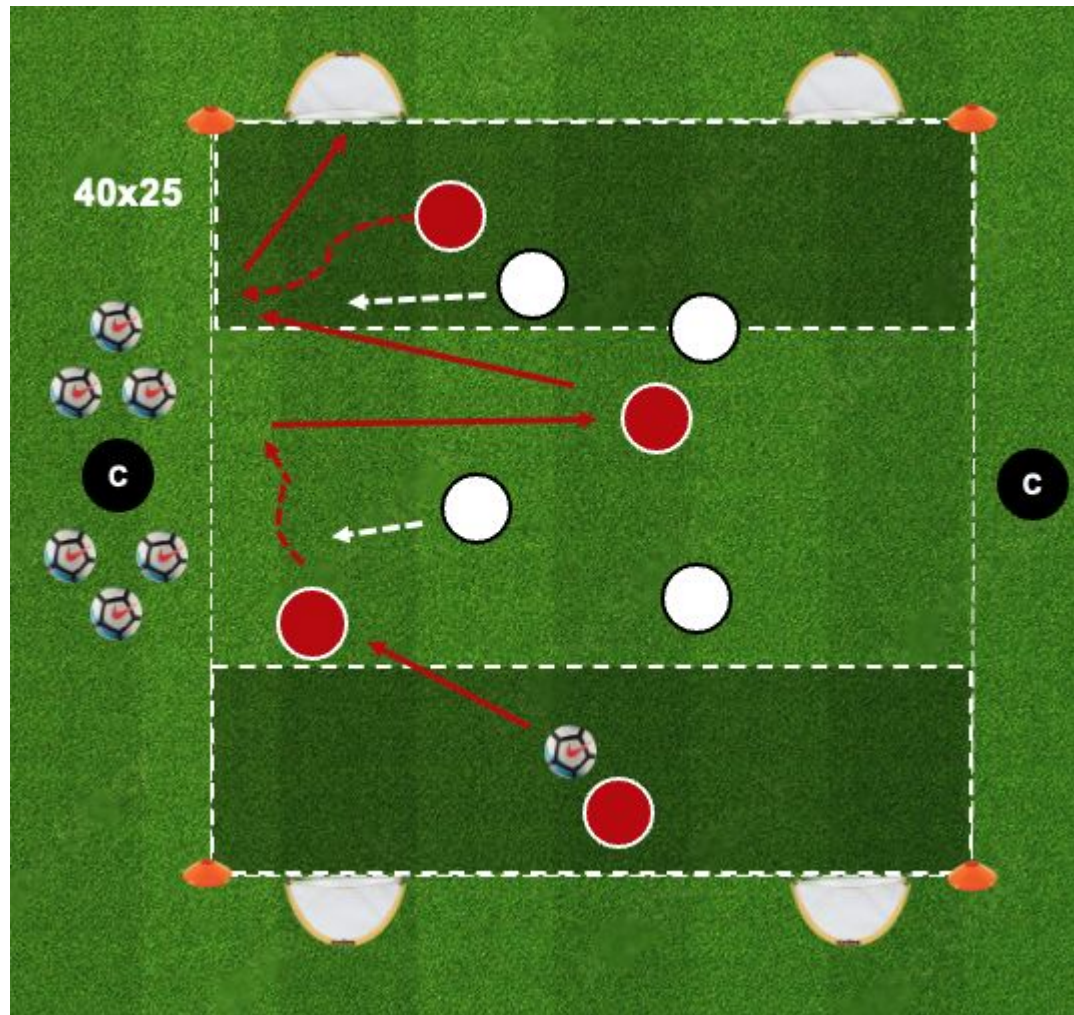


To consider:

- Identify direction of play when possible
- Decision making activities for players
- Ideal space for activity
- Proportional number of players to space
- Flow of play
- Rest work ratio



CONDITIONED SMALL-SIDED GAME



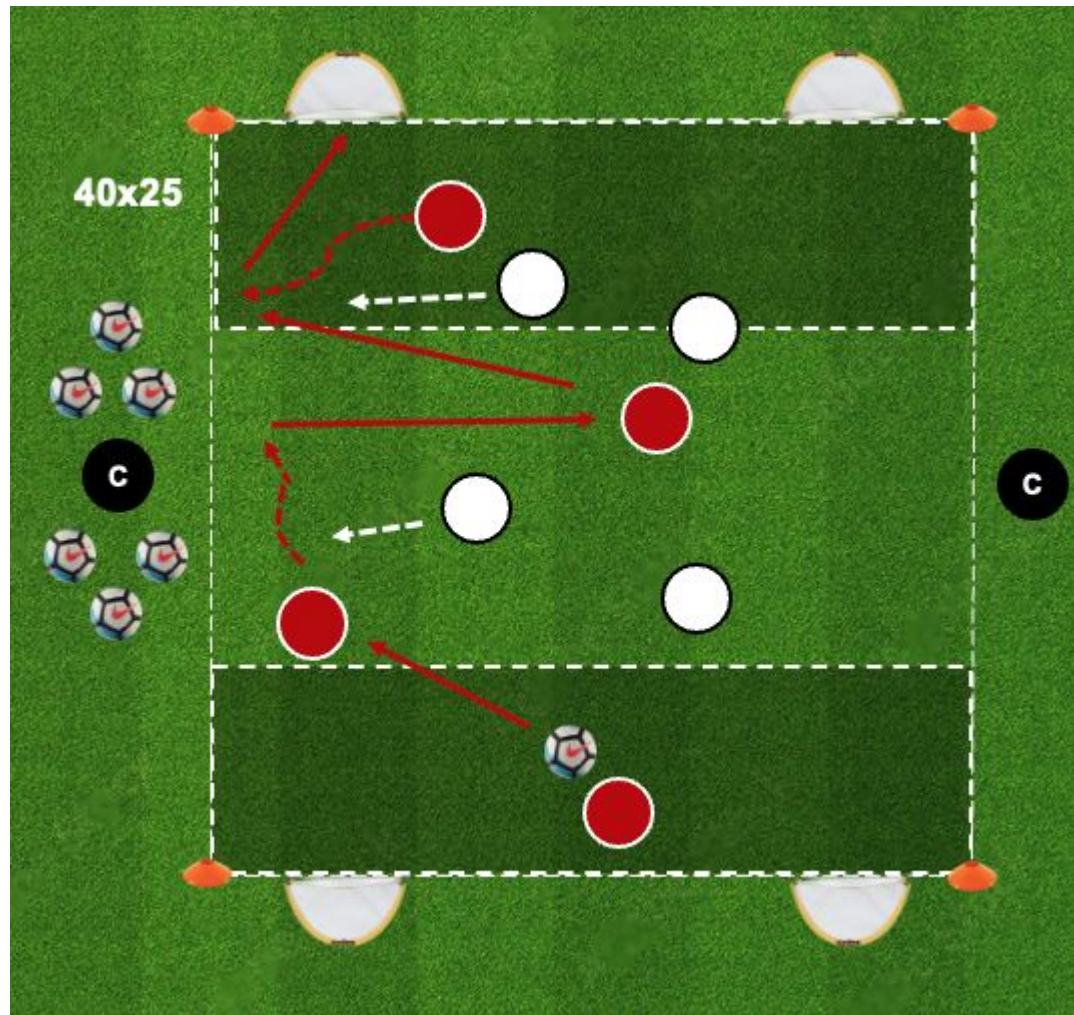
A directional game-practice situation involving teams of less than eleven-a-side.

It can be utilised for the coach to work technically or tactically and is ideal for developing the principles of play and team understanding.

Goals or targets of some design are employed to signify the successful end of attacks.

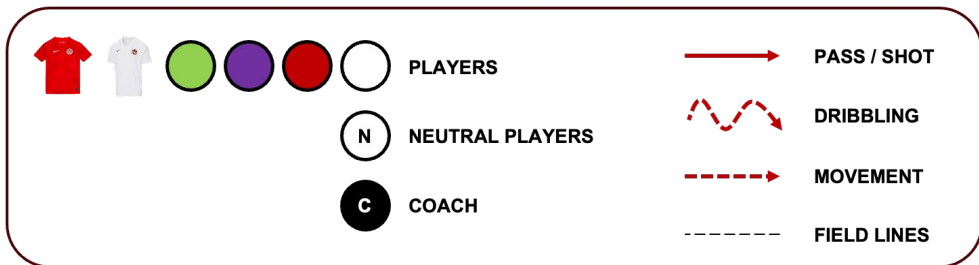
The coach will usually identify the problem/challenge for the players to explore.

CONDITIONED SMALL-SIDED GAME

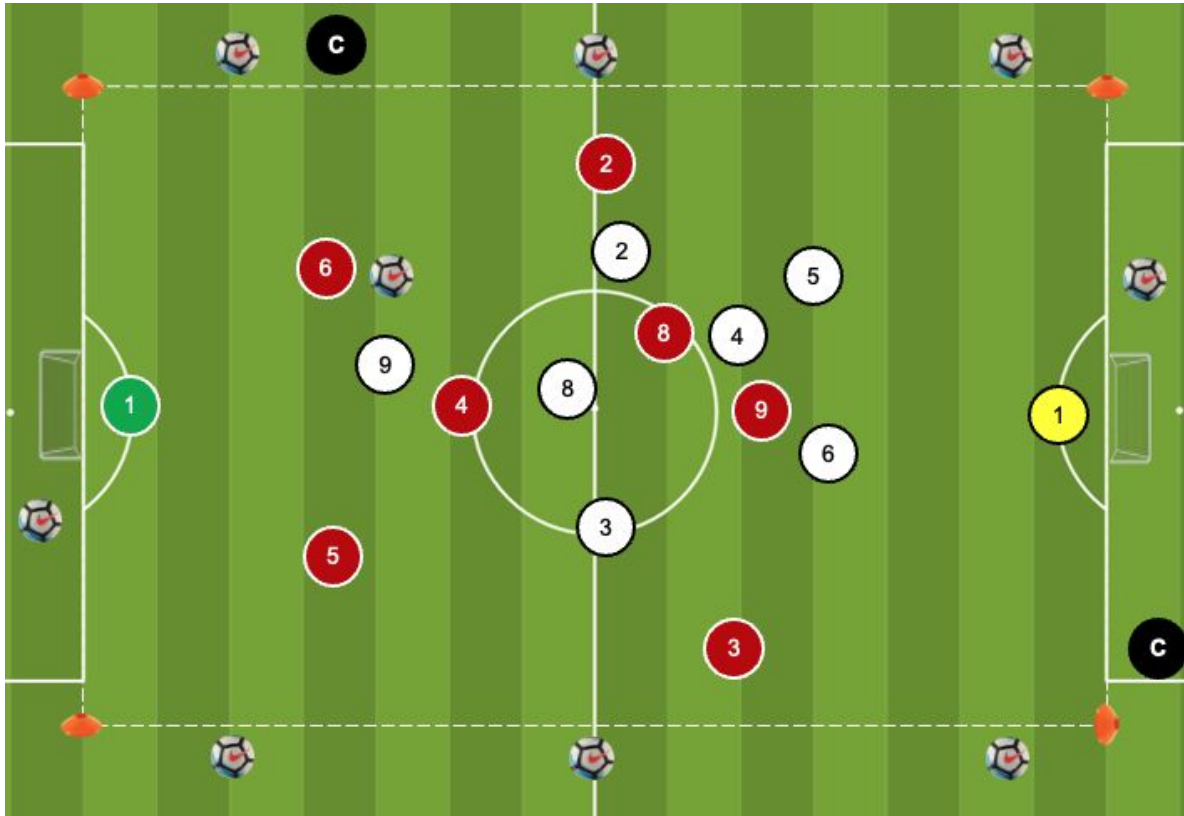


To consider:

- Symmetrical environment for both teams
- Tasks are the same for both teams
- Directional
- Target to score points
- Same number of players on both teams
- Players are free to move anywhere in the environment



SMALL-SIDED GAME (FIFA RULES)



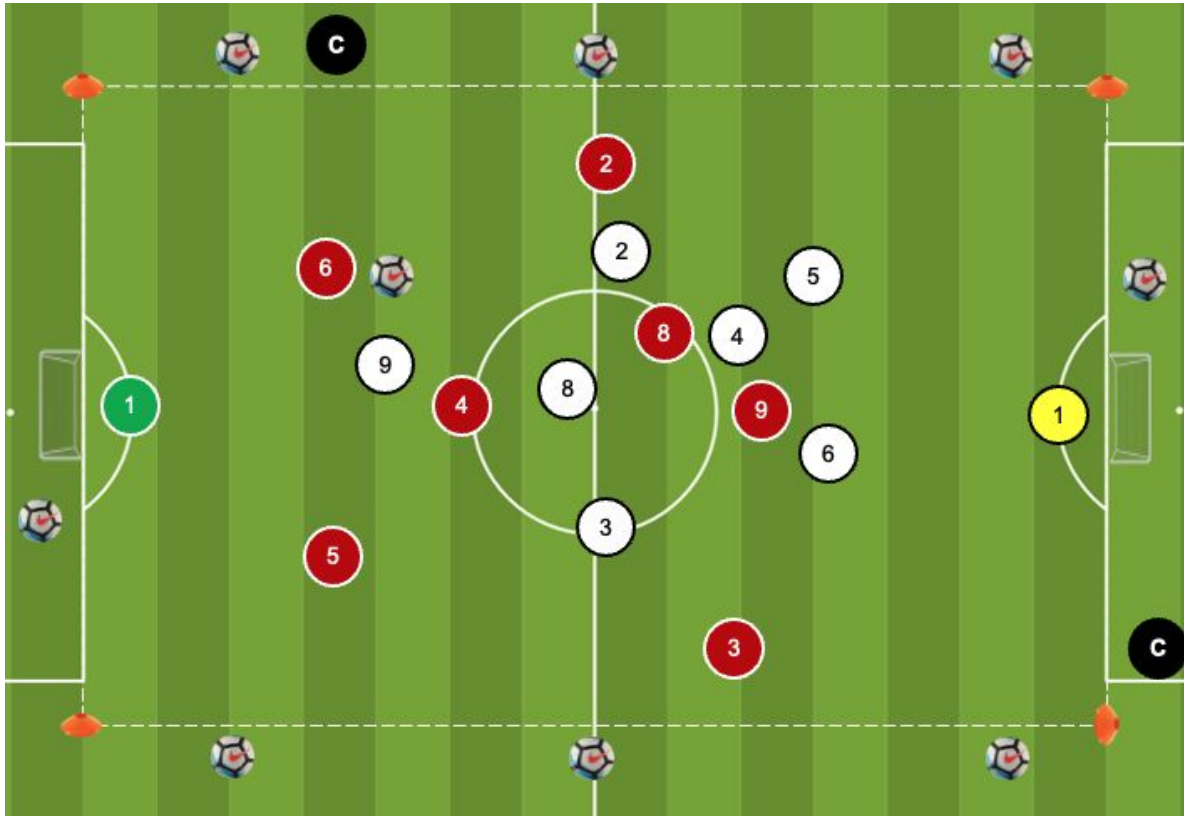
A directional game-practice situation involving goalkeepers playing in teams of less than eleven-a-side.

It can be utilised for the coach to work technically or tactically and is ideal for developing the principles of play and team understanding.

Working areas are adapted to suit the reduced numbers of players and official game rules are applied, although some may be modified.

The coach will usually work with one team and on one theme of work.

SMALL-SIDED GAME (FIFA RULES)



To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- FIFA Rules



PLAYERS



NEUTRAL PLAYERS



COACH



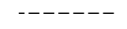
PASS / SHOT



DRIBBLING

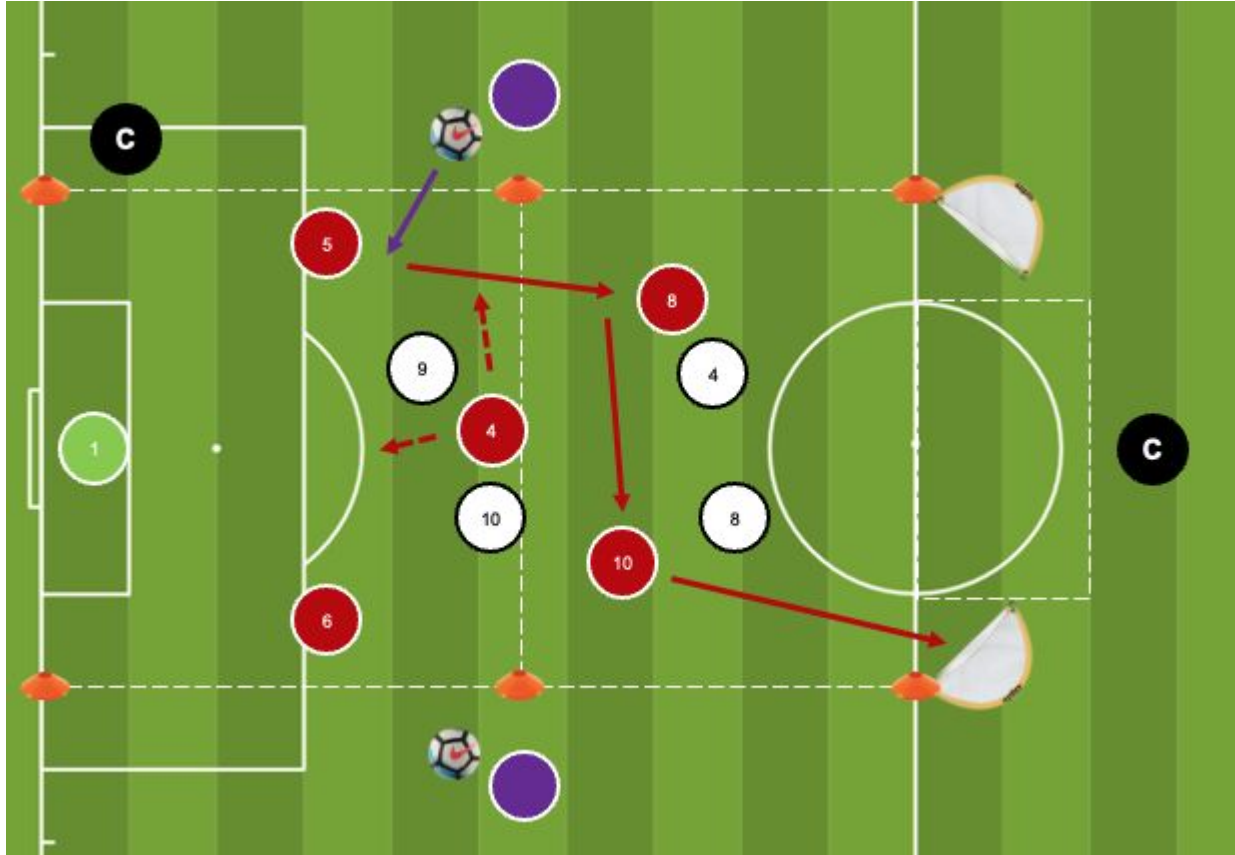


MOVEMENT



FIELD LINES

FUNCTIONAL

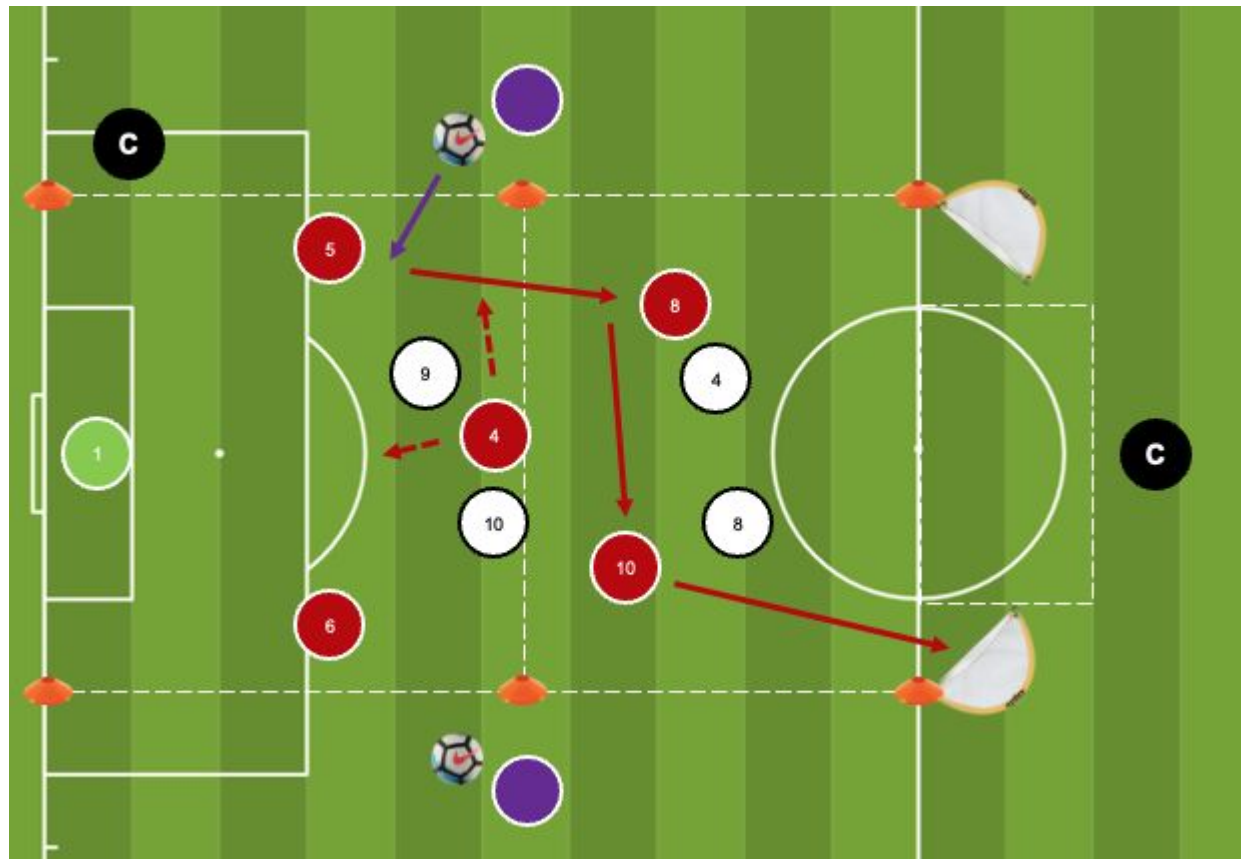


This is a practice situation in which a player or a small group of players develop an understanding of their attacking and/or defending roles, responsibilities and accompanying skills.

Practice will be best sited in the area of the field where the player operates in a game (11-aside) and only players who are primary or secondary in the development of role understanding at involved in the practice.

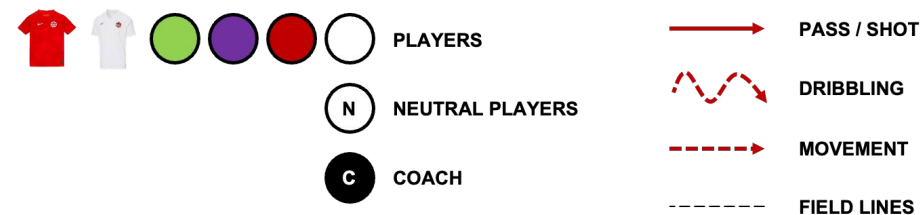
A functional session can include only one regular-size goal.

FUNCTIONAL (CENTRAL)

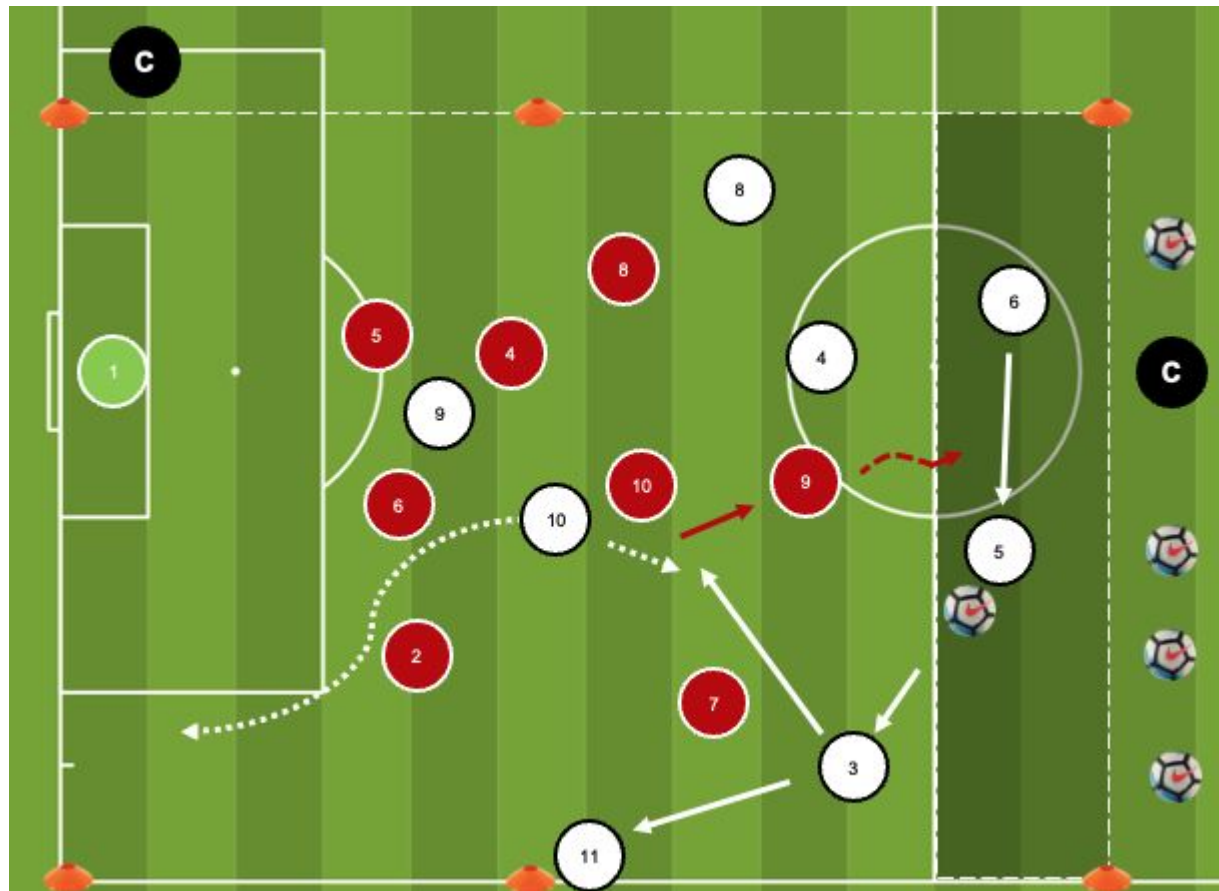


To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- Flow of activity (when does an action finish)
- Target Representation & Starting point(s)/Restarts

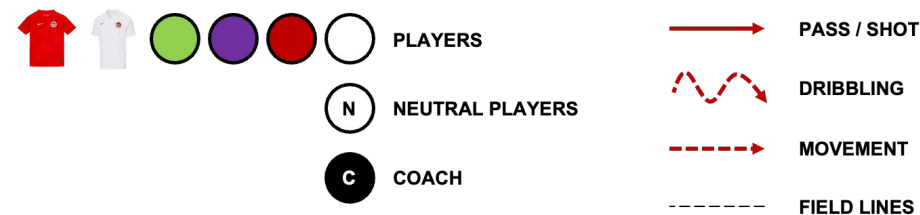


FUNCTIONAL (WIDE)

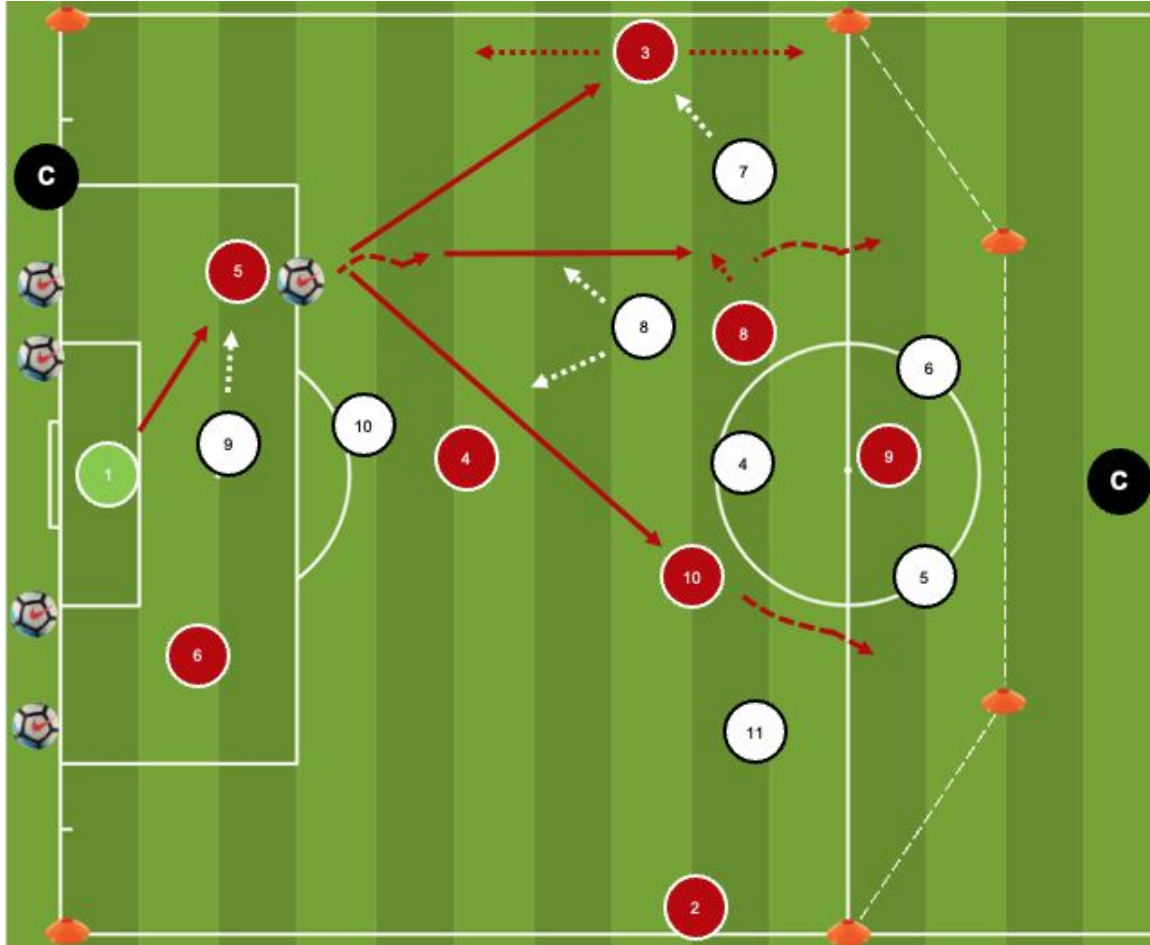


To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- Flow of activity (when does an action finish)
- Target Representation & Starting point(s)/Restarts



PHASE OF PLAY

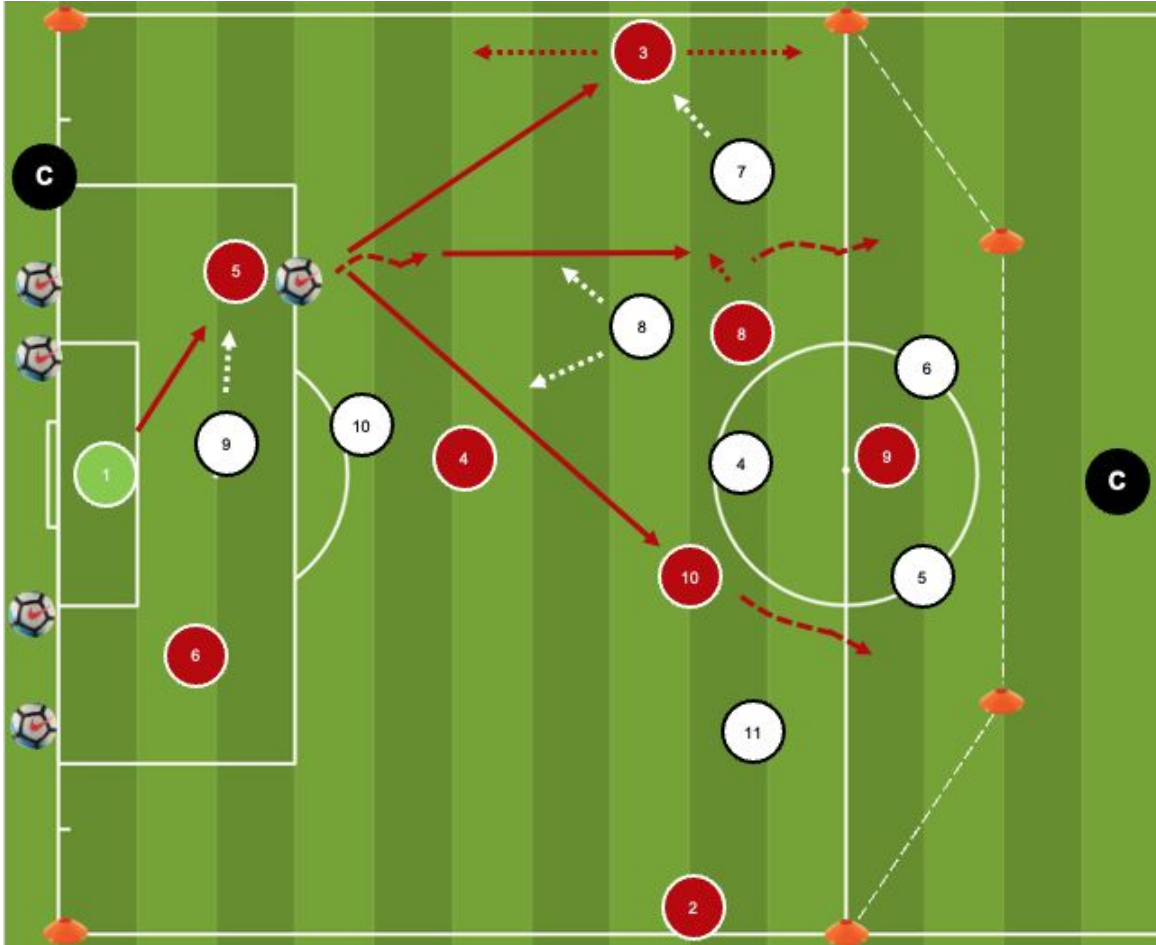


This is a practice situation utilizing the majority of the full width of the pitch but with a reduced length
Involves team units of players attacking or defending against opponents.

Ideal for developing group, unit and team tactical understanding.

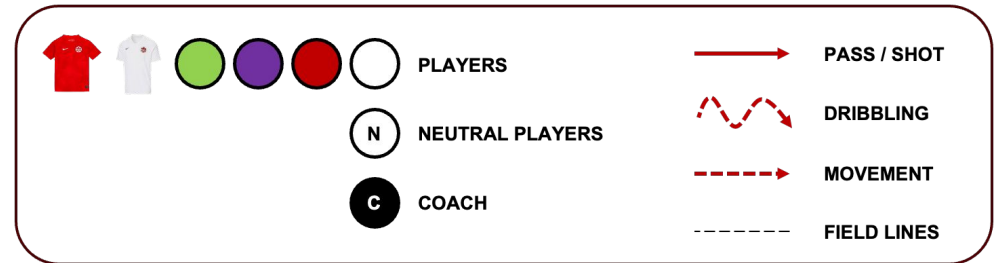
A phase of play must include only one regular-size goal.

PHASE OF PLAY

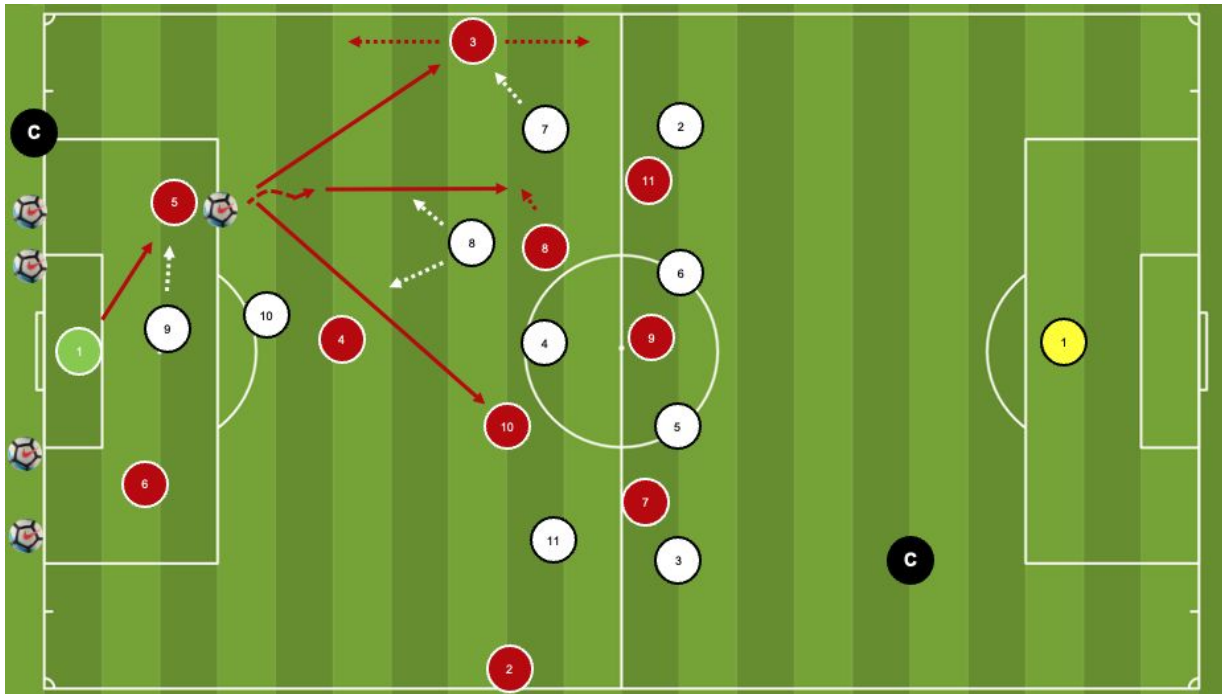


To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- Flow of activity (when does an action finish)
- Target Representation & Starting point(s)/Restarts



11-ASIDE

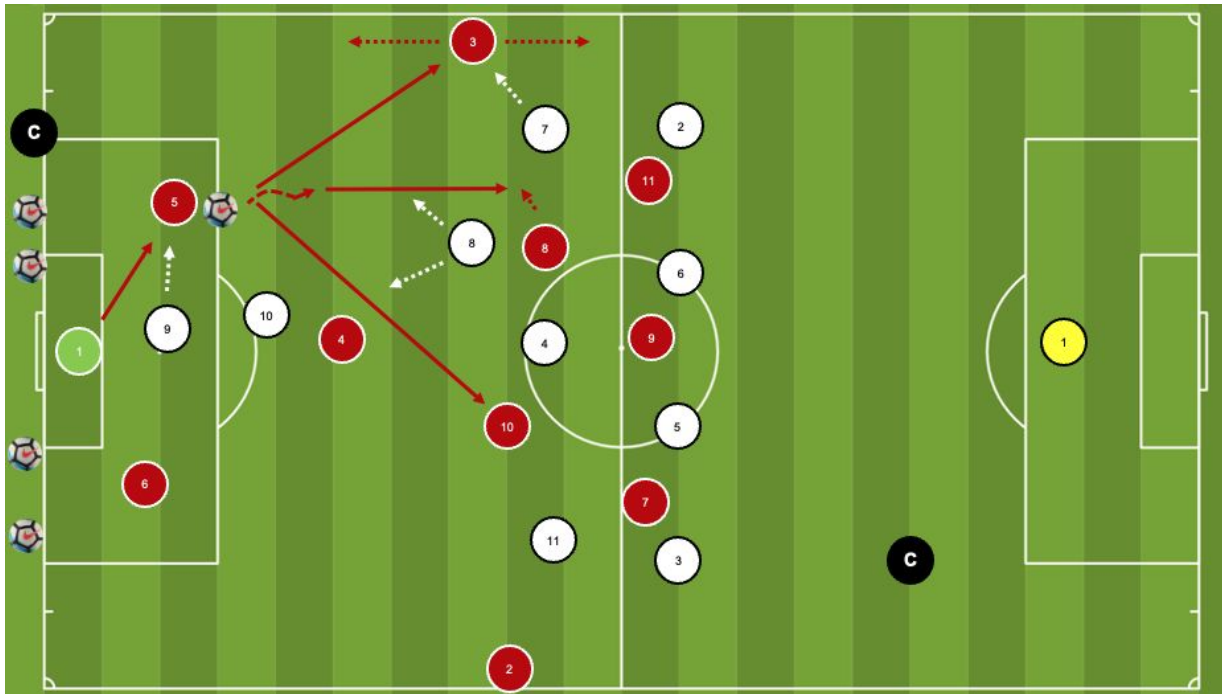


This is a practice situation utilizing the full width and length of the pitch but can also be reduced in length.

It involves team units of players attacking or defending against opponents and is ideal for developing group, unit and team tactical understanding.

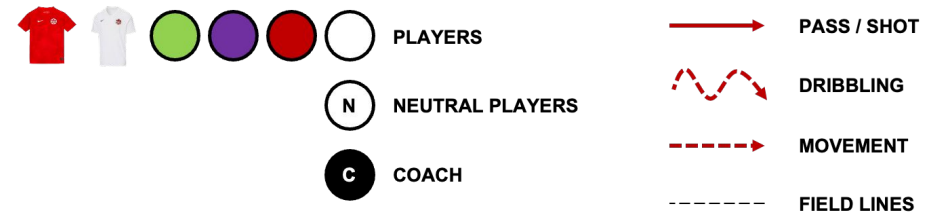
A key consideration is given to starting points to achieve an ideal amount of repetition with reference to the objective being worked on.

11-ASIDE

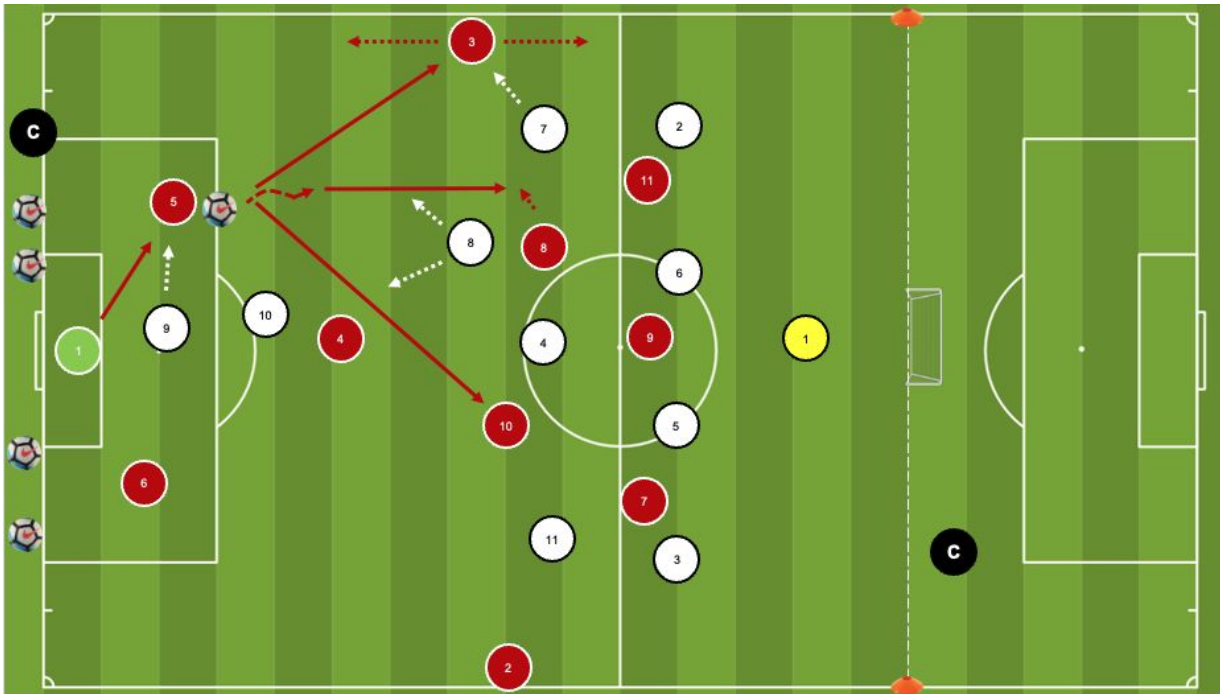


To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- Flow of activity (when does an action finish)
- Target Representation & Starting point(s)/Restarts

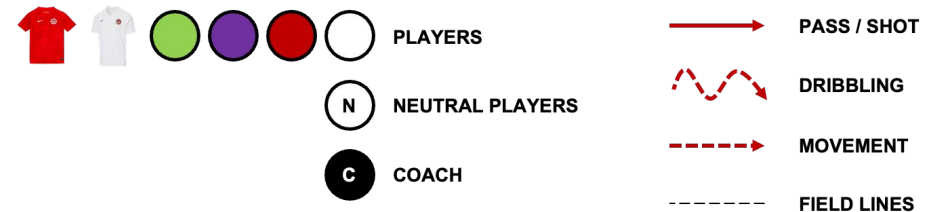


11-ASIDE $\frac{2}{3}$ FIELD

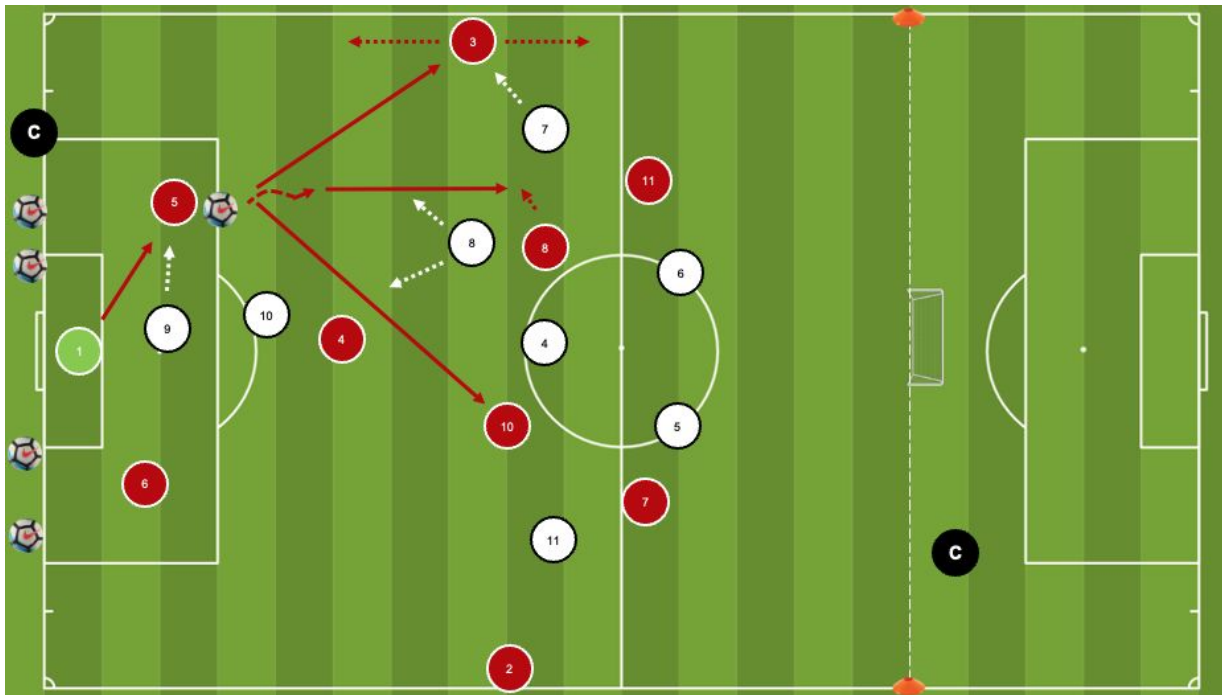


To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- Flow of activity (when does an action finish)
- Target Representation & Starting point(s)/Restarts

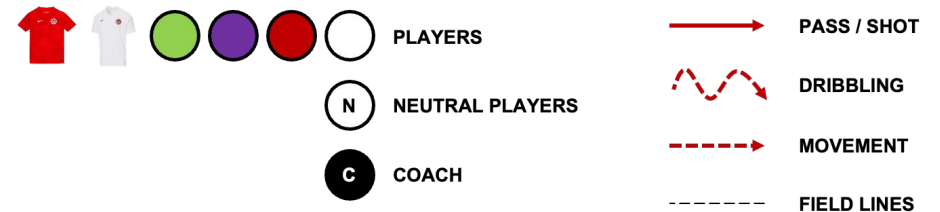


10 v 8



To consider:

- Identify System (formation) & strategy of both teams
- Area of field (which zone)
- Tactical role(s) of key primary and secondary players
- Flow of activity (when does an action finish)
- Target Representation & Starting point(s)/Restarts



ENVIRONMENT DESIGN FRAMEWORK

DESIGN

DEMANDS

EXPERIENCES - OBJECTIVES - LEARNING OUTCOMES

ORGANIZATION - STRUCTURE - ACTIVITIES

PITCH

PARAMETERS

REWARD

RELATE

PLAYERS

RESTRICT

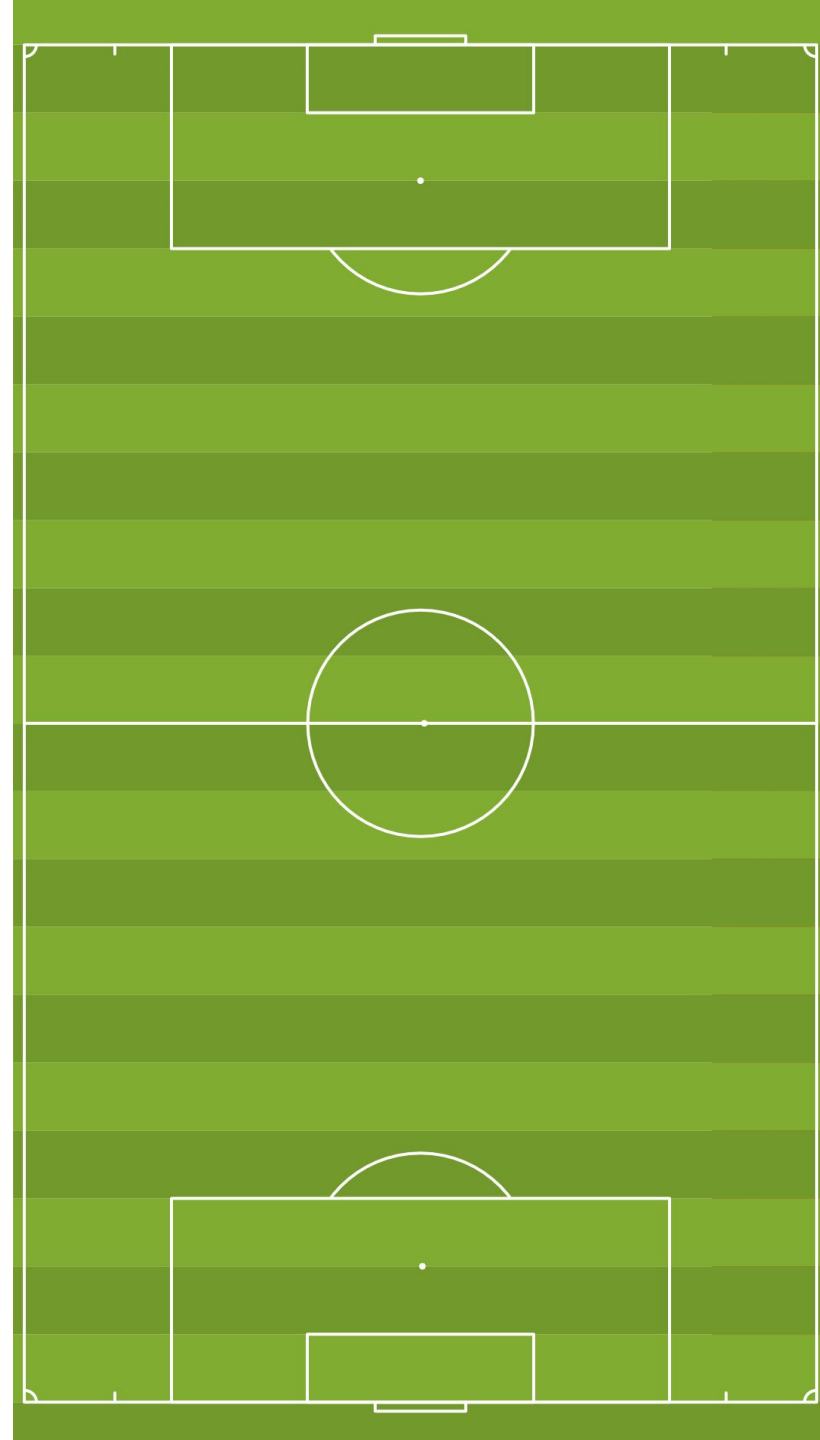
PITCH

The boundaries of the area that the players play within. This might be wide, narrow, big or small.

Small: Less space (relative to the number of players), Less time on the ball & High intensity

Long & Narrow: More space in front and behind defenders, Less space down the sides & Less intense

Wide & Short: More space down the sides (wide) & More movements and actions across the pitch



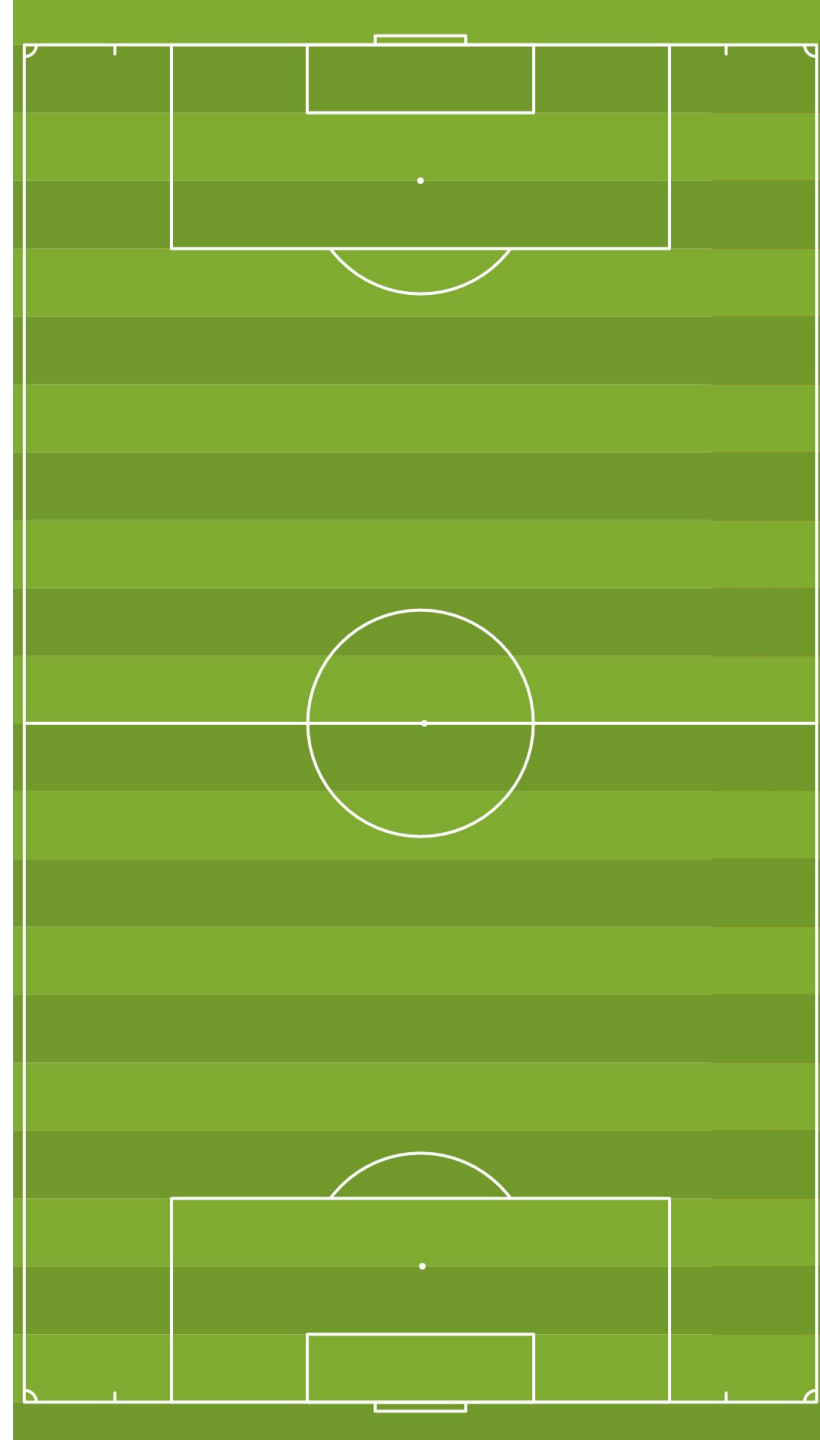
PARAMETERS

Any pitch markings we add within the boundaries to either limit players movement or guide their decision making. We might use horizontal or vertical thirds, a half-way line or a central circle.

Channels: Attackers to practice changing the direction of the attack & Defenders to practice getting and staying compact (positioning and movement).

Thirds/Quarters: Helping players with their positioning and movement, both in attack and defence.

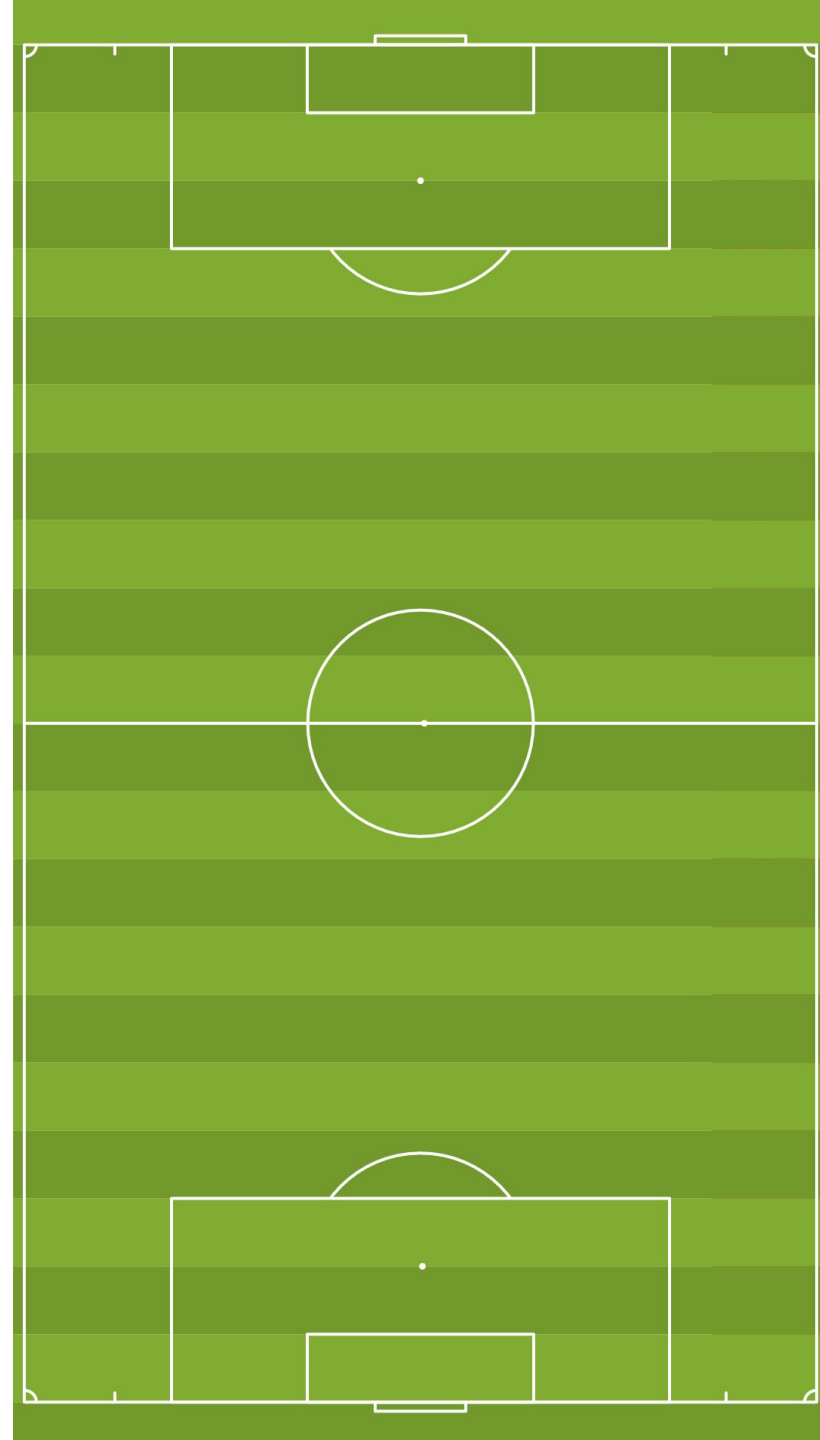
Halves: Helping players with their positioning and movement, both in attack and defence.



PLAYERS

The ways the **players are organized within or distributed across the pitch**. This distribution can support them to practice tasks that are most relevant to who they are and the characteristics they are being challenged to enhance.

We might do this with small numbers, bigger numbers distributed either evenly across both teams or unevenly (e.g. we are deliberately playing 9 vs. 8).



ENVIRONMENT DESIGN FRAMEWORK

DESIGN

DEMANDS

EXPERIENCES - OBJECTIVES - LEARNING OUTCOMES

ORGANIZATION - STRUCTURE - ACTIVITIES

PITCH

PARAMETERS

REWARD

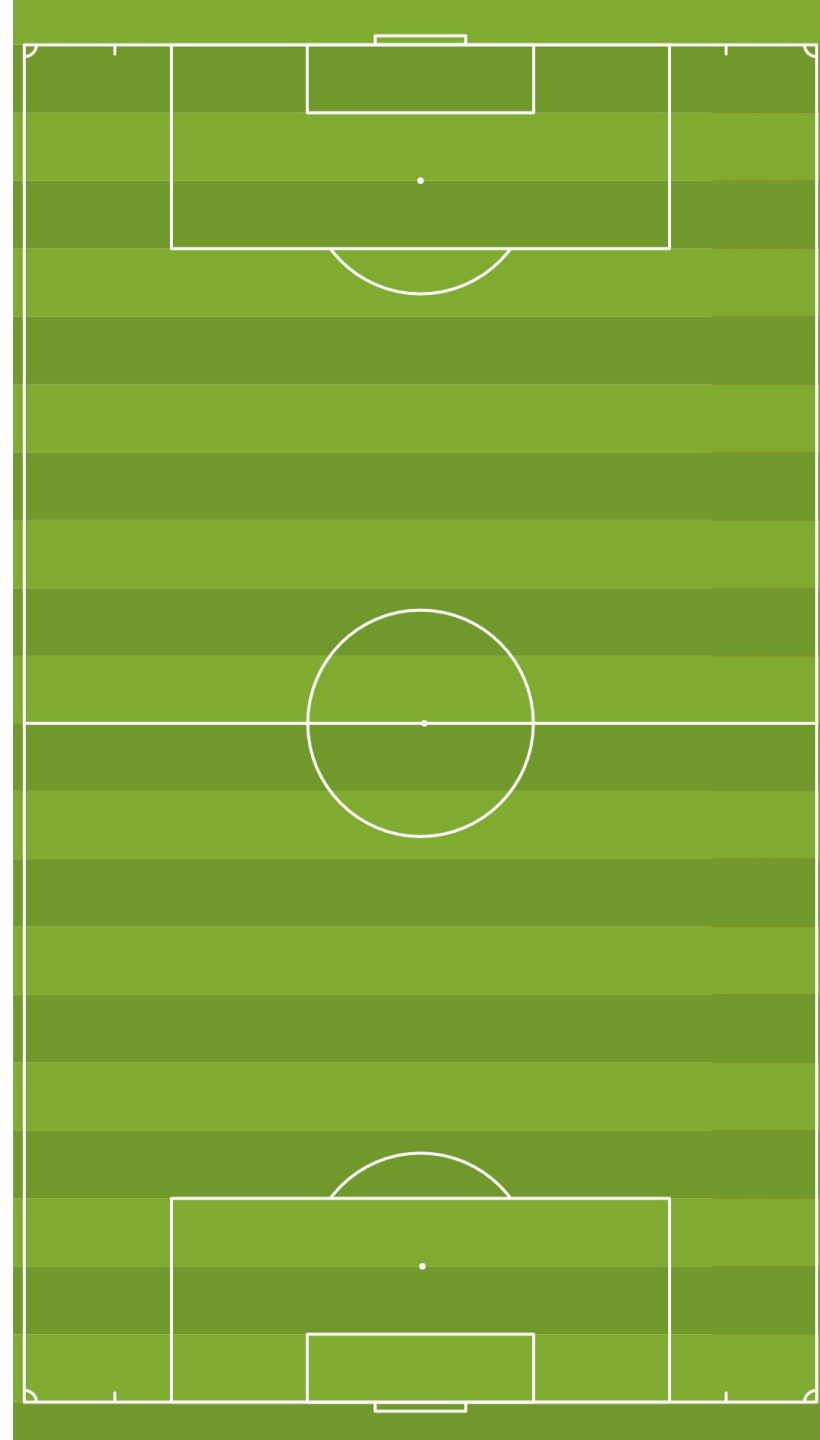
RELATE

PLAYERS

RESTRICT

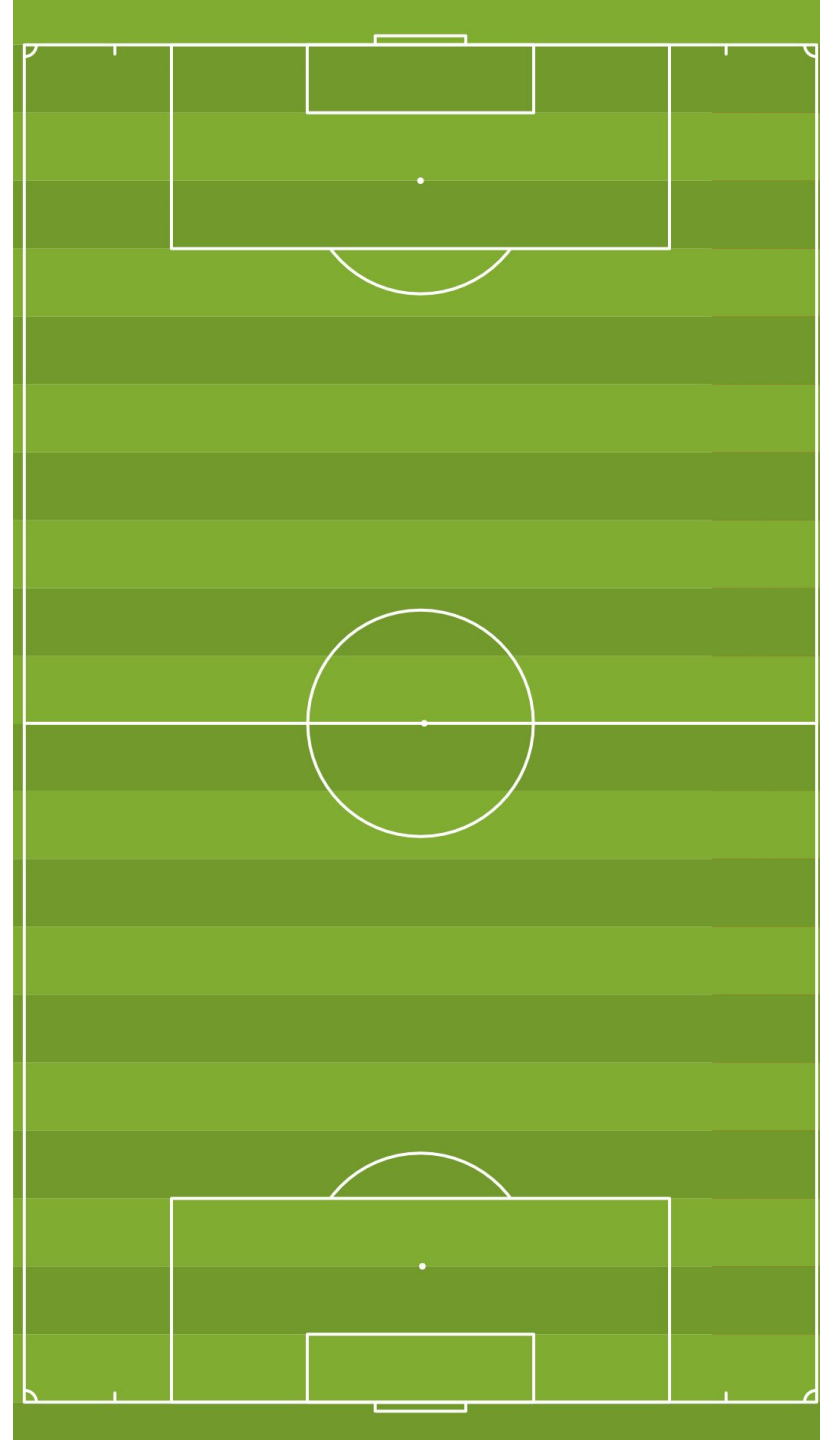
RESTRICT

A traditional way to constrain practice is to restrict the ball contacts, movements and/or decisions a player or team can make. Adopting this method is an **effective way to ensure lots of repetition of the affordances generated by the restriction.**



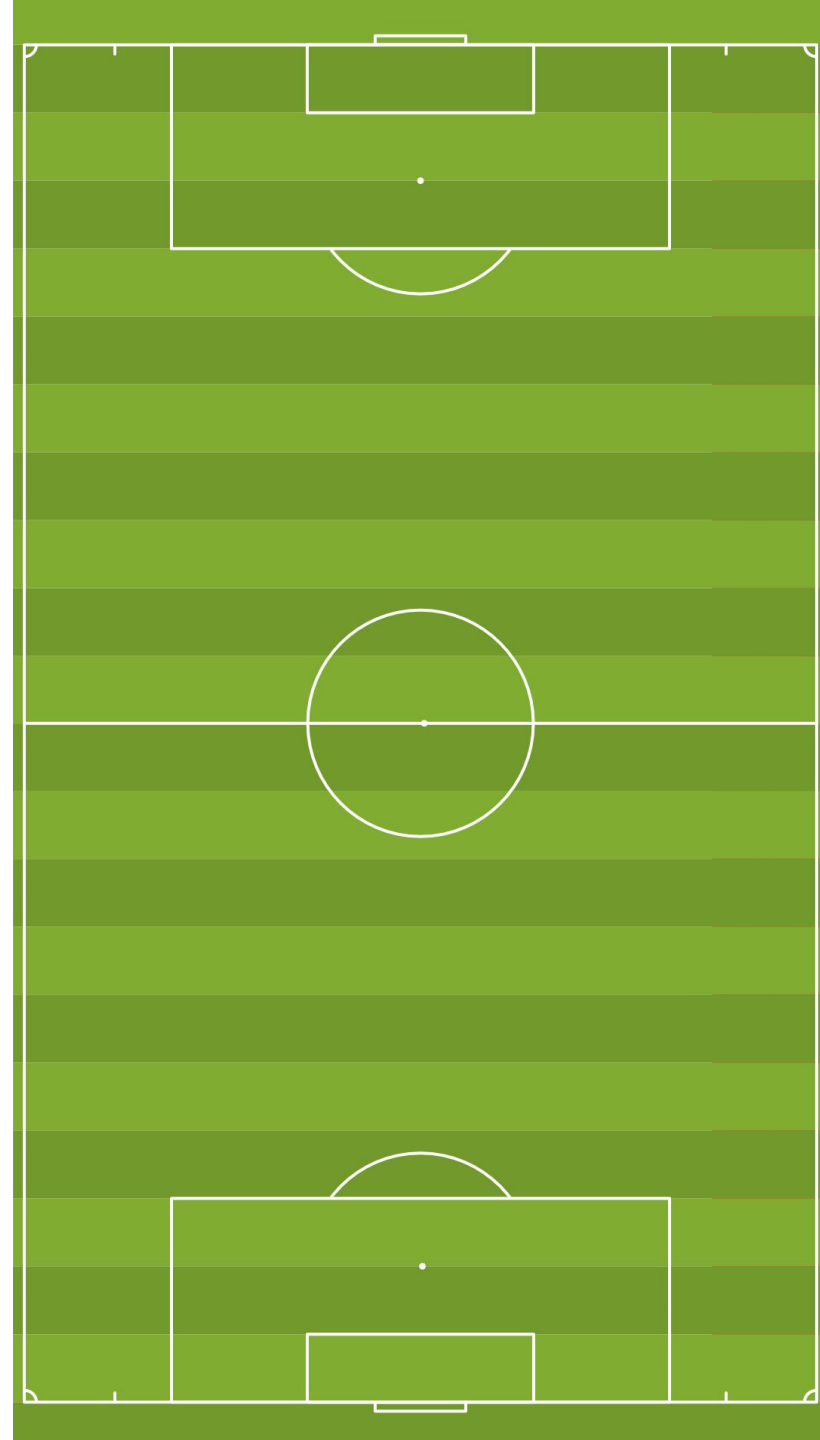
RELATE

Challenging players to relate a particular task to the situation occurring such as 'Recognize when to play forward'. By using the 'relate' method, **the coach plants a seed about the desired outcome without making it mandatory.**



REWARD

Coaches can use the idea of a 'reward' to encourage aspects of play linked to our agreed intentions. The reward method can act as a middle ground between the 'restrict' and 'relate' methods as the players aren't mandated to perform a certain action but are **likely to commit to it as the reward is greater.**



EXAMPLE:

PLAYING FORWARD

RESTRICT: All forward passes into next zones must be 1 touch

REWARD: However, many 1 touch passes used in attack = that number of goals when scoring (5 x 1 touch passes = 5 goals).



RELATE: Try to inject speed into attacks (if it's the right thing to do).

DEVELOPING TRAINING PRINCIPLES

Soccer-Problem: design the problem rather than the solutions.

Challenge: is there competition? Is it appropriate for the ability of the players?

Opposition: creating repetition without repetition

Realism: does it look like the game? Would it happen?

Enjoyment: are the players having fun & motivated by the experience?

EXAMPLE

IMPACT ON PLAYER DEVELOPMENT

“But suppose our aspiration is for young men or women who are developing the **skillset to adapt based on the circumstances that present themselves**. In that case, an alternative approach to coaching and practice design is perhaps required.”

(Bartlett, 2022)

“The desire for tactically adaptive players and teams has to align with our behaviour. If we **expose players to challenging problem-focused situations, navigate them collectively** and, importantly, hold our nerves as we are going through the messy, sometimes chaotic and unsettling nature of ‘learning to learn’.”

ENSKILMENT APPROACH

**An enskilment approach
views learning as
inseparable from ‘doing’ in
‘place’**

(Lave, 1990; Ingold, 2000).



ENSKILMENT APPROACH

“This means that creativity, developed and supported through an enskilment approach, is not pre-programmed as a thought to be enacted by the body or transmitted by a coach as a ‘way of doing’. Rather, it **emerges as the player interacts with key regulatory sources of information** to solve the dynamic, contextual problems experienced during competition.”

“A creatively enskiled player, then, would not be one who just thinks more divergently than their less creative counterpart, **but one who is better able to perceive and then exploit opportunities for action in their environment that others may not pick up** – thereby solving problems in functional, exceptional and adaptive ways.”

Woods et al., 2021)

DESIGNING ENVIRONMENTS & TASKS

“A task, when viewed through an enskilment approach, is best understood as a **practical, goal-directed activity undertaken by an individual interacting with an environment.**”

Ingold, 2000

“This more contemporary approach is influencing global change in soccer coaching and learning towards environments where players are **armed with the perceptual skills and self-confidence** to respond to the challenges they encounter, challenges that are continually changing due to varied opposition, environmental conditions and game situations.”

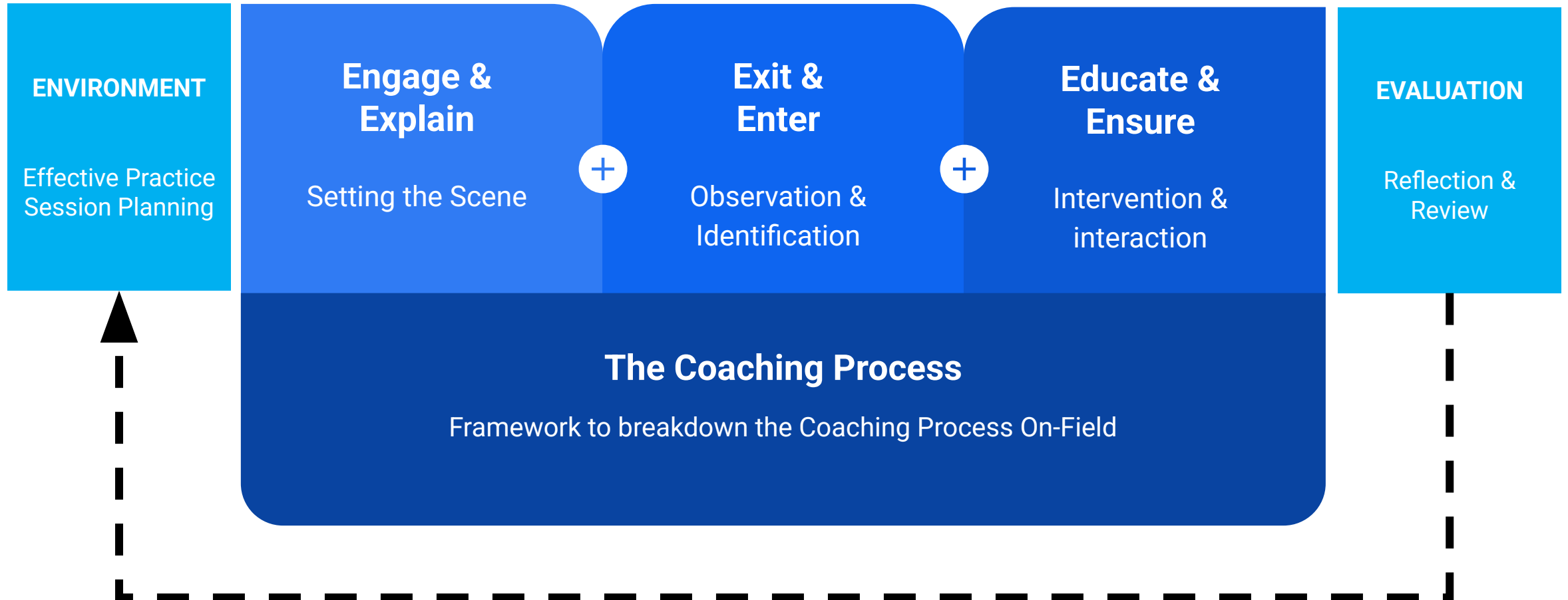
(Bartlett, 2022)

COACHING IS COMPLEX

This metaphor illustrates the inherent **intractability of coaching**. Attempting over-control risks squashing the very talent that the coach is trying to nurture. But a laissez-faire approach risks this talent being dissipated unproductively.

Jones et al. (2008)

THE COACHING PROCESS FRAMEWORK



THE COACHING PROCESS: EXAMPLES

Engage:

- Pre-session video
- Send players session plan
- Interactive tasks to prime

Explain:

- Whiteboard
- Mini-field
- Demonstration

Exit:

- Review the environment
- Where to stand & why
- Do you verbally leave the space

Enter:

- Observation
- Timing of Intervention
- Flow

Educate:

- Intervention approach
- Details of the intervention

Ensure:

- Opportunities for interaction
- Opportunities for rehearsal

COACHING TOOLS

Practical coaching tools to support the teaching styles theory:

Natural Stoppages:

- Discuss experience or opportunities.
- Attune them to important information.

Freeze & Recreate:

- Re-create the scenario.
- Demonstrate & discuss (multiple options, moving the ball and teammates).
- Rehearse at game speed / go live if successful.



COACHING TOOLS

Individual-Team Challenges:

- Reward-Restrict-Relate (See Environment Design Framework).

Individual Coaching:

- While the play is happening, providing individual coaching to the players.
- Speak to them individually about specific feedback.

Mini Group Discussions:

- Create small groups and set them a task/challenge.
- Have them discuss their objectives.



The Spectrum of Teaching Styles

The command style (a)

Teacher makes all the decisions before, during, and after the lesson. All exercises are performed after a certain stimulus, such as a whistle.

The practice style (b)

Teacher shows the task and gives room for learners to practice at their own pace. Teacher follows and gives feedback.

The reciprocal style (c)

Students work in pairs and take turns observing & giving feedback to each other using performance criteria.

The self-check style (d)

Similar to reciprocal style but students work on their own.

The inclusion style (e)

Teacher sets out tasks with varying levels of difficulty. Pupils decide which task is most appropriate for their abilities and motivations.

Guided discovery (f)

The teacher uses questions to guide the learners towards a single predetermined response or solution.

Convergent discovery (g)

Learners discover new content by producing a single correct response to an unfamiliar specific problem, question, or situation.

Divergent discovery (h)

Teacher designs problems that engage students to find multiple solutions.

Learner-designed individual program (i)

Students have the opportunity to design, develop and present a series of tasks organized into a personal program

Learner-initiated style (j)

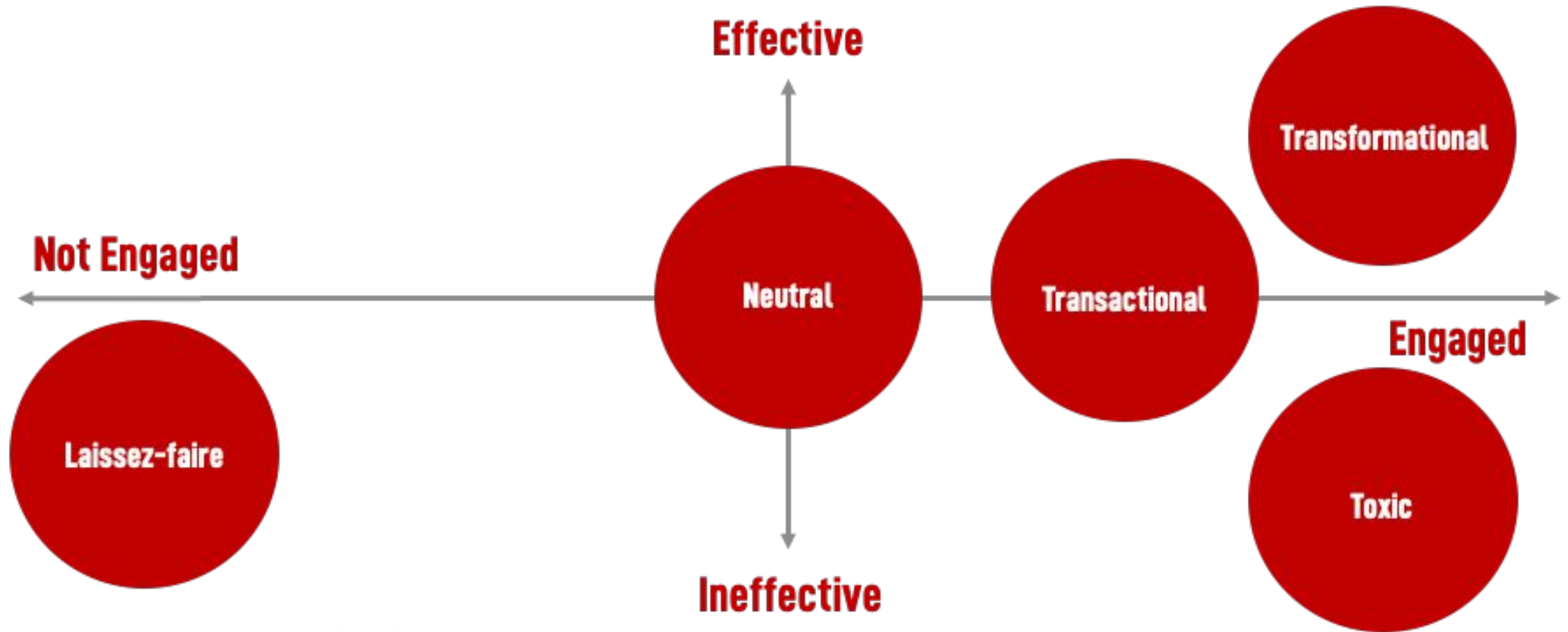
The learner initiates their own learning experience by deciding the learning intent, objectives, the logistics, procedures, and assessment criteria.

Self-teaching (k)

The learner accepts the decision-making roles of both teacher and learner.

Teaching style	Interaction	Role of practitioner	Role of participant
Command (A)	Practitioner makes decisions. Participant copies and complies with decisions and instructions.	Instructing	Copying
Practice (B)	Practitioner sets up opportunities giving feedback to participant who is working at own pace on tasks set.	Establishing	Repeating and improving
Reciprocal (C)	Participants work together, receiving feedback from each other. Practitioner provides reference points for feedback.	Supporting	Performing and peer assessing
Self-check (D)	Practitioner sets criteria for success. Participants check own performance against these.	Directing	Self assessing
Inclusion (E)	Practitioner sets out a variety of tasks/opportunities. Participants select which task is most appropriate for their abilities and/or motivations.	Facilitating	Selecting
Guided discovery (F)	Practitioner uses questions and tasks to gradually direct participants towards a pre-determined learning target.	Questioning	Uncovering
Convergent discovery (G)	Practitioner sets or frames problems. Participant attempts to find most appropriate solutions.	Guiding	Finding out
Divergent discovery (H)	Practitioner sets or frames problems. Participant attempts to create possible solutions.	Prompting	Creating
Learner designed (I)	Practitioner decides on area of focus. Participants develop within this area, drawing on practitioners' expertise.	Advising	Initiating
Learner initiated (J)	Participant decides on how and what they are aiming for. Practitioner drawn on for support as needed.	Mentoring	Deciding
Self teach (K)	Participant engages in development on their own.	N/A	Self-determined

FULL-RANGE MODEL OF COACHING BEHAVIOUR



Adapted from Bass & Riggio (2006)

TRANSFORMATIONAL COACHING

1. Discussing and modeling pro-social values & behaviors
 2. Showing vulnerability and humility
 3. Discussing goals & expectations
 4. Expressing confidence in athletes' capabilities
 5. Implementing a collective vision
 6. Providing meaningful & challenging tasks & roles
 7. Eliciting athlete input
 8. Sharing decision making/leadership responsibilities
 9. Emphasize the learning process
 10. Showing interest in athletes' feelings & perspectives
 11. Recognize athlete accomplishments & contributions
- Idealized Influence**
- Inspirational Motivation**
- Intellectual Stimulation**
- Individualized Consideration**

PHYSICAL

EXAMPLE: Vertical Jump

SOCIAL-EMOTIONAL

EXAMPLE: Confident

PSYCHOLOGICAL

EXAMPLE: Brave

POSITIONAL PROFILE



POSITION: GOALKEEPER

SKILL SET PRIORITIES (TECHNICAL-TACTICAL)

EXAMPLE: Distribution

ATTACKING ORGANIZATION

EXAMPLE: Offer depth to retain possession

DEFENSIVE ORGANIZATION

EXAMPLE: Protect positioning

ATTACKING TRANSITION

EXAMPLE: Secure the first pass

DEFENSIVE TRANSITION

EXAMPLE: Structure team shape

Youth Physical Development Model

Youth Physical Development (YPD) model (variation model based off Long Term Player Development) and offers a comprehensive approach to the development of young males and females.

Within the model, training emphasis is highlighted by increasing font size (i.e., the greater the font size, the more important it is to train for that fitness quality). For example, the model shows that a 12- to 13-year-old boy should primarily focus their training on strength, power, speed, agility, and sport-specific skill (SSS) development, with a reduced focus on hypertrophy, mobility, fundamental movement skill (FMS), endurance, and metabolic conditioning.

(Lloyd and Oliver, 2012)

YOUTH PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT (YPD) MODEL FOR FEMALES																					
CHRONOLOGICAL AGE (YEARS)	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21+	
AGE PERIODS	EARLY CHILDHOOD			MIDDLE CHILDHOOD					ADOLESCENCE								ADULTHOOD				
GROWTH RATE	RAPID GROWTH			↔ STEADY GROWTH ↔					ADOLESCENT SPURT					↔ DECLINE IN GROWTH RATE							
MATURATIONAL STATUS	YEARS PRE-PHV									← PHV →			YEARS POST-PHV								
TRAINING ADAPTATION	PREDOMINANTLY NEURAL (AGE-RELATED)									↔ COMBINATION OF NEURAL AND HORMONAL (MATURITY-RELATED)											
PHYSICAL QUALITIES	FMS		FMS		FMS		FMS														
	SSS		SSS		SSS		SSS														
	Mobility		Mobility					Mobility													
	Agility		Agility					Agility							Agility						
	Speed		Speed					Speed							Speed						
	Power		Power					Power							Power						
	Strength		Strength					Strength							Strength						
	Hypertrophy					Hypertrophy		Hypertrophy									Hypertrophy				
	Endurance & MC			Endurance & MC							Endurance & MC						Endurance & MC				
TRAINING STRUCTURE	UNSTRUCTURED			LOW STRUCTURE					MODERATE STRUCTURE				HIGH STRUCTURE				VERY HIGH STRUCTURE				

a

YOUTH PHYSICAL DEVELOPMENT (YPD) MODEL FOR MALES																							
CHRONOLOGICAL AGE (YEARS)	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21+			
AGE PERIODS	EARLY CHILDHOOD			MIDDLE CHILDHOOD							ADOLESCENCE							ADULTHOOD					
GROWTH RATE	RAPID GROWTH			↔			STEADY GROWTH				↔			ADOLESCENT SPURT				↔			DECLINE IN GROWTH RATE		
MATURATIONAL STATUS	YEARS PRE-PHV										←			PHV		→			YEARS POST-PHV				
TRAINING ADAPTATION	PREDOMINANTLY NEURAL (AGE-RELATED)										↔			COMBINATION OF NEURAL AND HORMONAL (MATURITY-RELATED)									
PHYSICAL QUALITIES	FMS		FMS			FMS			FMS														
	SSS		SSS			SSS			SSS														
	Mobility		Mobility							Mobility													
	Agility		Agility							Agility				Agility									
	Speed		Speed							Speed				Speed									
	Power		Power							Power				Power									
	Strength		Strength							Strength				Strength									
	Hypertrophy										Hypertrophy		Hypertrophy						Hypertrophy				
	Endurance & MC		Endurance & MC									Endurance & MC				Endurance & MC							
TRAINING STRUCTURE	UNSTRUCTURED			LOW STRUCTURE					MODERATE STRUCTURE				HIGH STRUCTURE			VERY HIGH STRUCTURE							

b

What is Periodization

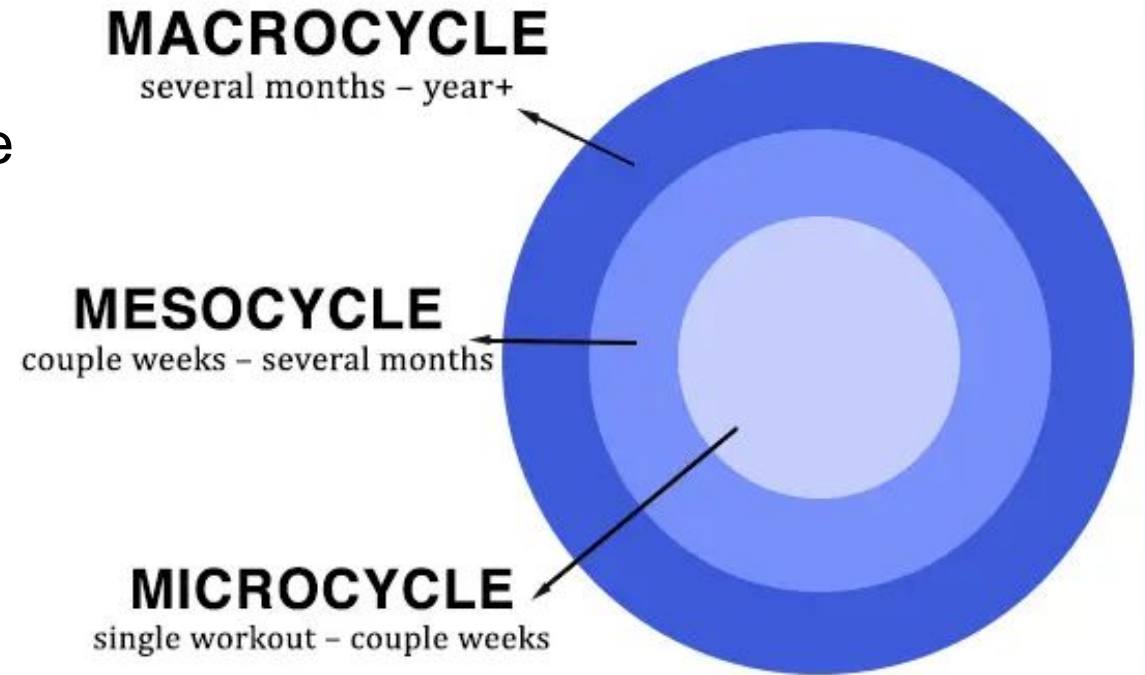
PERIODIZATION: Division of the training year or training time into periods to meet training objectives.

MACROCYCLE: For a yearly training plan, the macrocycle is 1 year. In a seasonal plan, the macrocycle is 1 season.

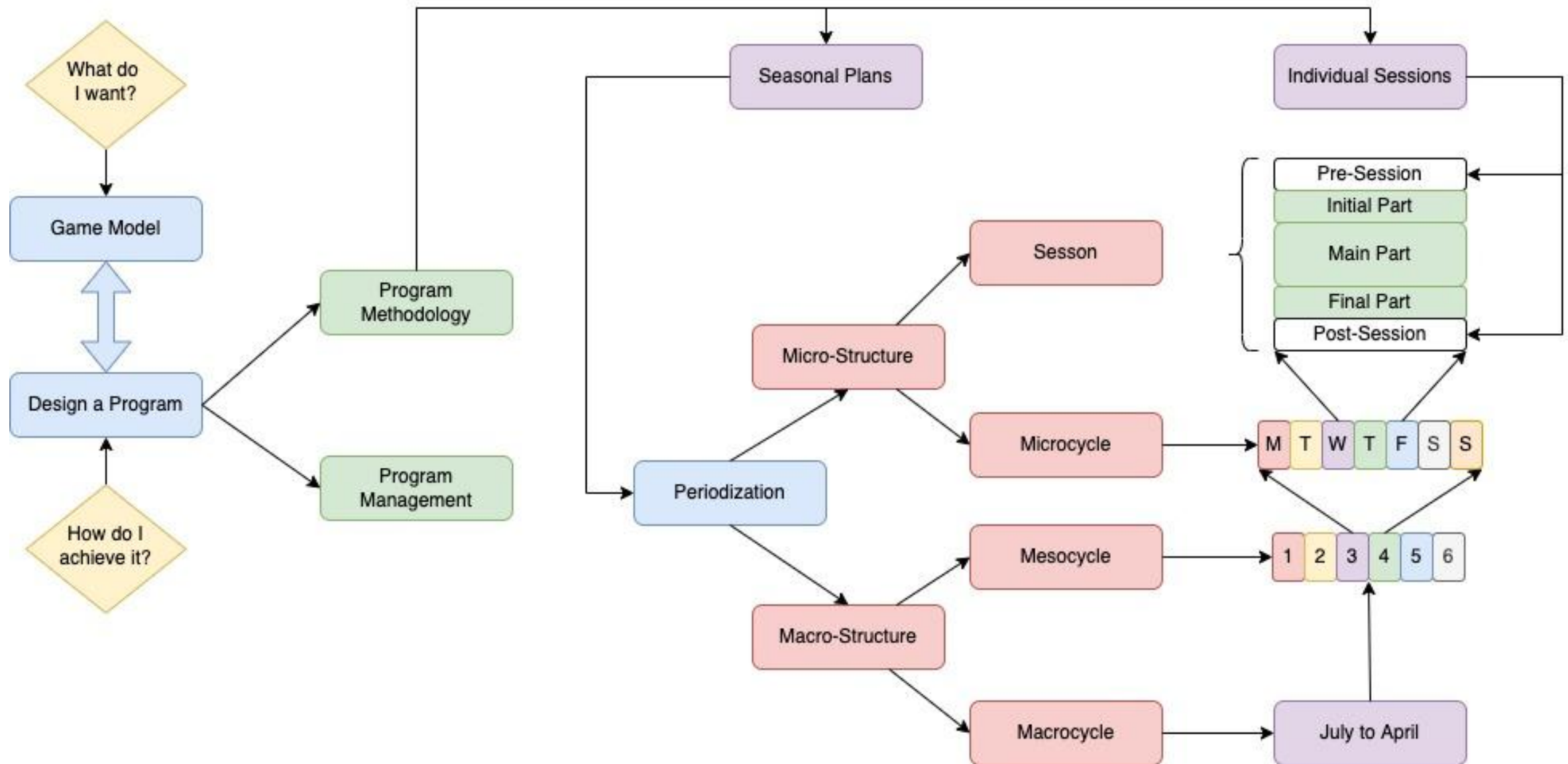
MICROCYCLE: A week of training (7 days)

MESOCYCLE: A series of microcycles linked together by a training theme. Phases are mesocycles.

PERIOD: Divisions of a seasonal plan into training themes. The periods of a sport program are preparation, competition and transition.



Soccer Program Considerations



Periodization Structures

You can divide a sport program or season into periods, if you know the general pattern according to which sport form evolves in the short term. Periods promote the progressive development of athletic abilities and prepare participants for their major competitions.

PERIOD	BEGINNING	END
PREPARATION	First practice of the program	First official competition of the program
COMPETITION	First official competition of the program	Last competition of the program
TRANSITION	Last competition of the program	Last structured training activity of the program



Preparation Phase - Accumulation and Intensification

The accumulation phase is like laying the foundation for future performance improvements:

- During this phase, athletes focus on building a base level of fitness, strength, and endurance through consistent training.
- The main goal of the accumulation phase is to increase the athlete's capacity to handle more intense training loads in the later phases.
- Athletes may work on developing general skills and fitness components during this phase, such as aerobic endurance and basic strength.

The intensification phase follows the accumulation phase and is aimed at increasing the intensity and specificity of training.

- During this phase, athletes focus on higher intensity workouts, more sport-specific activities, and fine-tuning skills needed for competition.
- The main goal of the intensification phase is to push the athlete to their limits, improve performance in specific areas, and peak at the right time for competitions.
- Athletes may work on developing more sport-specific skills, power, speed, and tactics during this phase.

Preparation Phase - Accumulation and Intensification

When in the preparation phase consider accumulation (volume) first then intensification. An example would be:

- Volume - 1. Using medium spaced possession drills with larger numbers (>5) before progressing to large amounts of 11v11 work.
- 2. Using smaller spaces and larger numbers (>3) for SSGs before progressing to 1v1s-3v3s in medium-larger spaces.
- Intensity - 1. Ramp up intensity by either increasing the size of grids to accumulate more distance or high-intensity running, or increasing the duration of bouts. For example - using 4v4 SSG in a small grid for 2 min intervals, then progressing to a medium or large grid and increasing the bout to 4 mins. The relationship is inverse - if you increase the size, decrease the duration initially, then slowly increase the duration. Or vice versa - increase duration then slowly increase the size week over week.

Accumulation and Intensification Examples

Accumulation

- Using medium spaced possession activities with larger numbers (>5) before progressing to large amounts of 11v11 work.
- Using smaller spaces and larger numbers (>3) for SSGs before progressing to 1v1s-3v3s in medium-larger spaces.

Intensification

- Increase the intensity by either enlarging the grids to cover more distance through high-intensity running or extending the duration of each interval.
 - For example - using 4v4 SSG in a small grid for 2 min intervals, then progressing to a medium or large grid and increasing the bout to 4 mins.
- The relationship is inverse: when you increase the size, decrease the duration initially, then gradually increase the duration. Conversely, you can increase the duration first and then slowly increase the size week by week.

Weekly Objective Example - **Preparation Phase - Tactical:** Introduce DO Zones 1-2 SYSTEM. **Tactical Principles:** Tight team - Nothing through, Show wide - Win wide. **Skill Sets:** Front foot mentality, Contest every ball. **Physical:** Endurance (Develop). **Mental:** Concentration & Competitive Edge. **Social:** Self-less

MICROCYCLE
TEMPLATE

	EXAMPLE	MATCH DAY	MD +1	MD +2	MD +3	MD -3	MD -2	MD -1	MATCH DAY
PHYSICAL OVERVIEW	ENDURANCE								
MOMENT	DO								
OBJECTIVE	ESTABLISH A COMPACT SHAPE THAT FORCES THE OPPONENTS INTO WIDE AREAS - ESTABLISH DEFENSIVE SHAPE - ROLE OF THE CF & HOW WE ADAPT - SKILL SETS TO WIN WIDE								
DURATION	90 MINS								
RPE	8								
SESSION METHODOLOGY	WHOLE- PART- WHOLE								
ACTIVITY TYPES	SSG PHASE OF PLAY 9v9								

